# 17 REASONS WHY

TWELVE DECISIONS

01 TRADE HERE, NOT THERE

02 LIGHT BEATS DENSE

03 EXPLORE FIRST, SIGN UP LATER

04 ONE THING PER SCREEN

05 LOCK THE DOOR, THEN KNOCK

06 COMPARE, DON'T REMEMBER

07 SAME APP, DIFFERENT PATHS

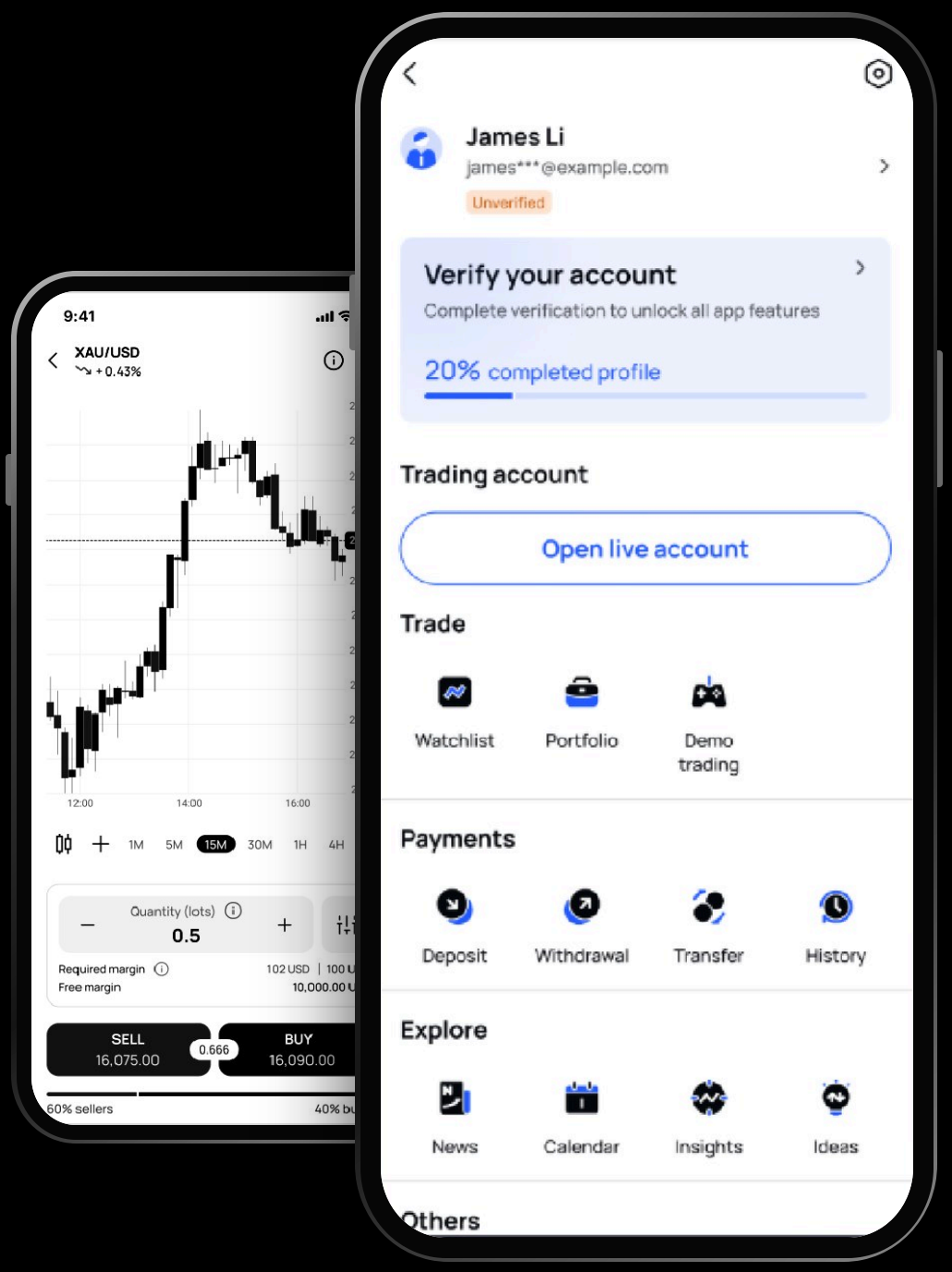
08 ASK LATER, NOT LESS

09 100+ CODES, 17 REASONS

10 A REJECTION YOU CAN ACT ON

11 NO DEAD ENDS

12 SPECIFY EVERY SCENARIO



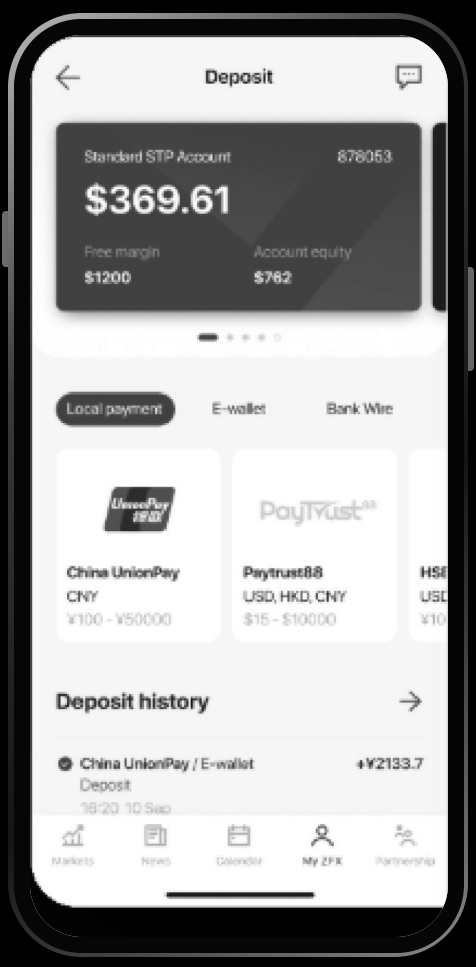

***ZEAL / ZFX:*** *TRADING UX ACROSS WEB, MOBILE AND PWA. UX/UI DESIGNER, REMOTE CONTRACT, JUNE 2022 TO JUNE 2025.*

*OWNED TRADING PLATFORM, ONBOARDING,* ***KYC*** *AND TRANSACTION FLOW DESIGN. WHAT FOLLOWS IS HOW EACH DECISION WAS MADE.*

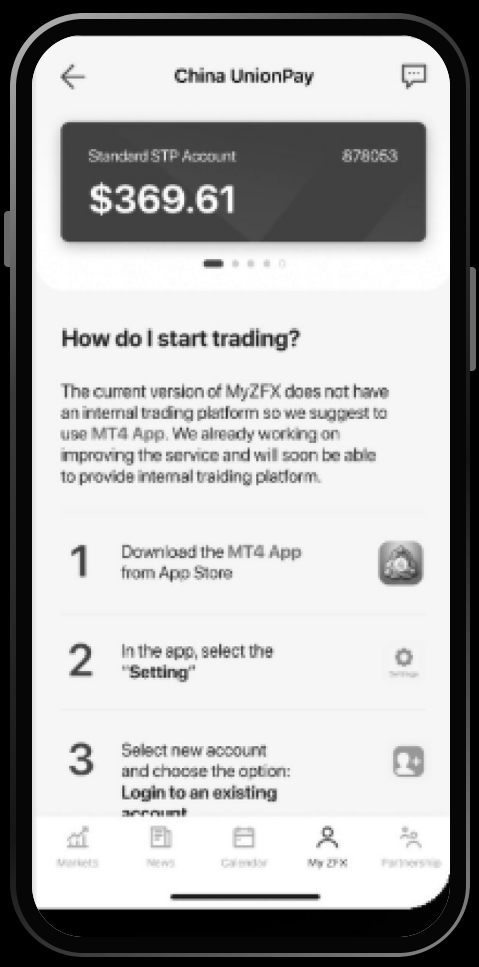
# TRADE HERE, NOT THERE

## THE PROBLEM

*THE OLD MYZFX APP COULD ONLY TAKE DEPOSITS AND MANAGE THE ACCOUNT.* ***NO TRADING INSIDE AT ALL.***




*OLD APP: DEPOSIT*




*OLD APP: "HOW DO I START TRADING?"*

*TO TRADE, PLEASE* ***DOWNLOAD ANOTHER APP.***

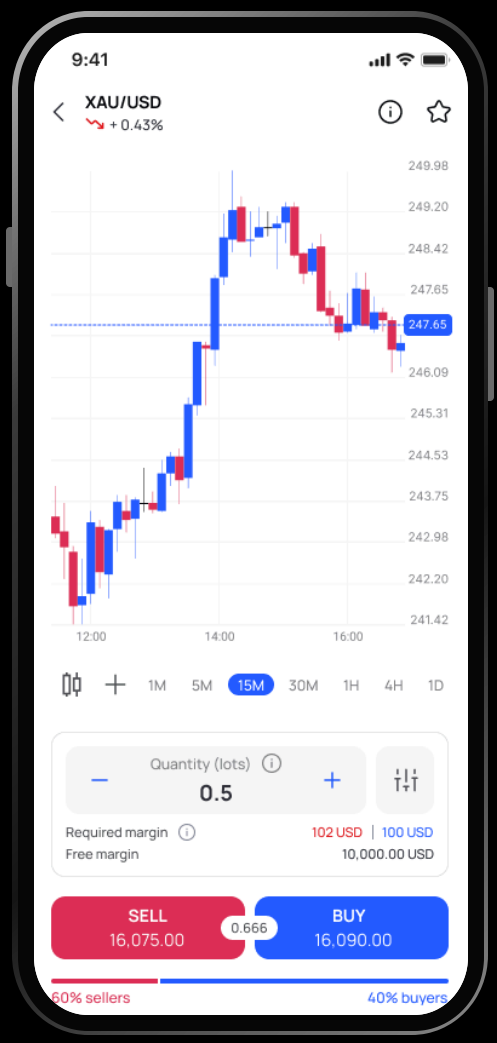
*USERS WERE SENT TO A* ***SEPARATE MT4 APP*** *TO DO THE ONE THING THEY CAME FOR.*

## THE DECISION

***BRING TRADING INTO THE PRODUCT.*** *WATCHLIST, CHART AND ORDER TICKET LIVE IN ONE APP.*



*A TRADING APP YOU COULDN'T TRADE IN.* ***THAT WAS THE FIRST THING TO FIX.***

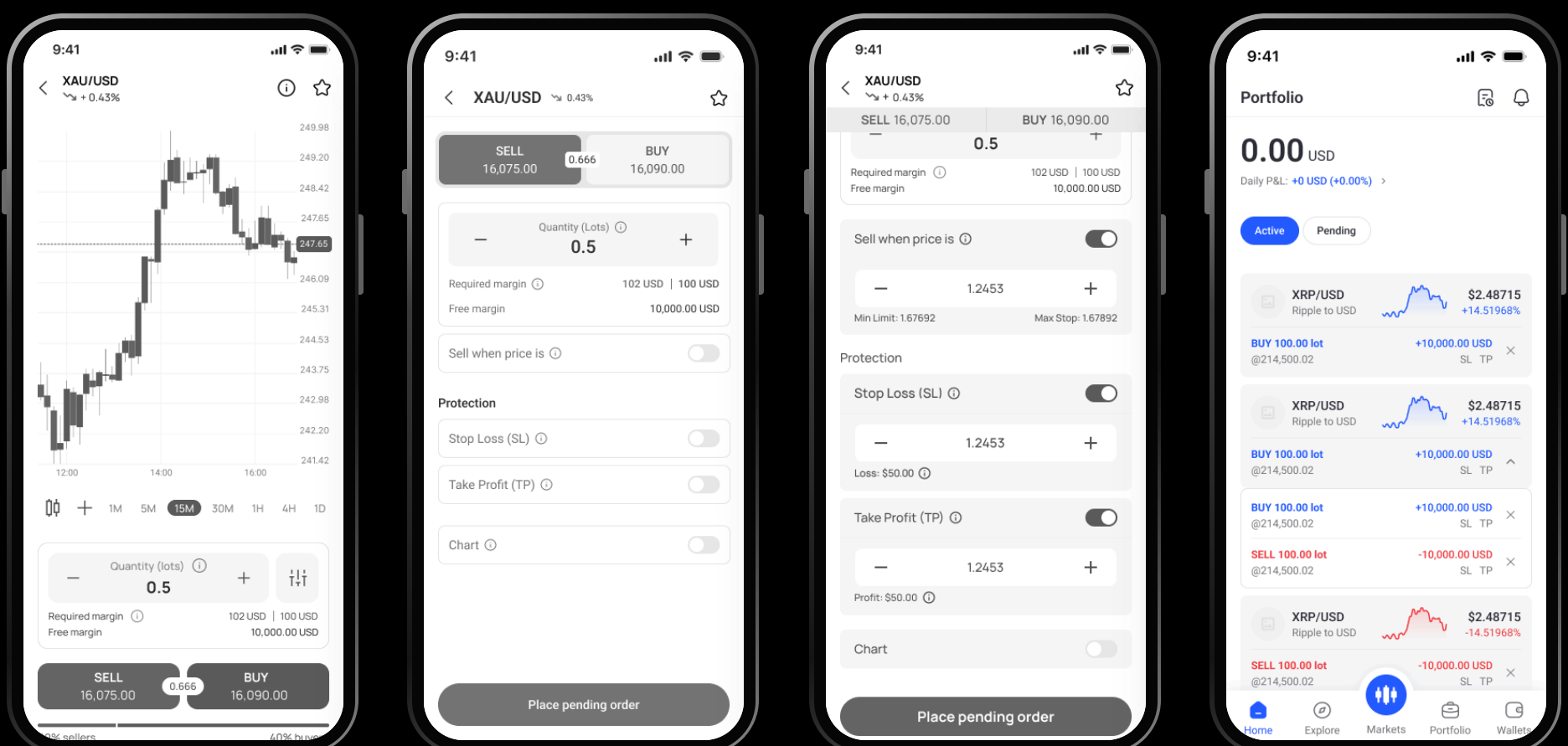



*NEW: CHART & ORDER TICKET*

# KNOW THE COST BEFORE YOU TAP

## WHAT "TRADING INSIDE" BECAME

*ONE CONTINUOUS PATH: **CHART, TICKET, PROTECTION, PORTFOLIO**. NO HAND-OFF, NO SECOND APP.*




*1. CHART + QUICK TICKET* *2. FULL TICKET* *3. PROTECTION ON* *4. OPEN POSITIONS*

## WHAT THE TICKET SHOWS, AND WHEN

*QUANTITY SITS NEXT TO **REQUIRED AND FREE MARGIN**, SO THE COST OF A TRADE IS VISIBLE WHILE YOU SET IT.*

*STOP LOSS AND TAKE PROFIT SHOW THE OUTCOME **IN MONEY**, RIGHT UNDER THE FIELD: "LOSS: $50.00", "PROFIT: $50.00".*

*A PENDING ORDER IS **ONE TOGGLE**, "SELL WHEN PRICE IS", WITH THE MIN LIMIT AND MAX STOP PRINTED BELOW IT.*

*EVERY OPEN POSITION KEEPS ITS **SL AND TP TAGS** AND A CLOSE BUTTON IN THE LIST.*

*NOBODY SHOULD FIND OUT WHAT A TRADE COSTS **AFTER** PLACING IT.*

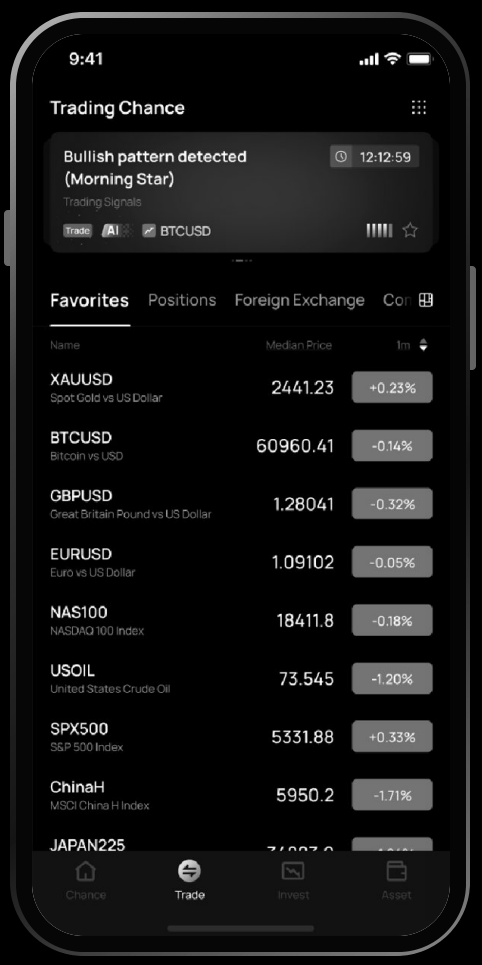


# LIGHT BEATS DENSE

## ROUND ONE

*THE FIRST CONCEPT ROUND WENT **DARK AND DENSE**. WE WERE TESTING HOW MUCH STRUCTURE THE TRADING, CHART AND ORDER FLOWS COULD TAKE.*

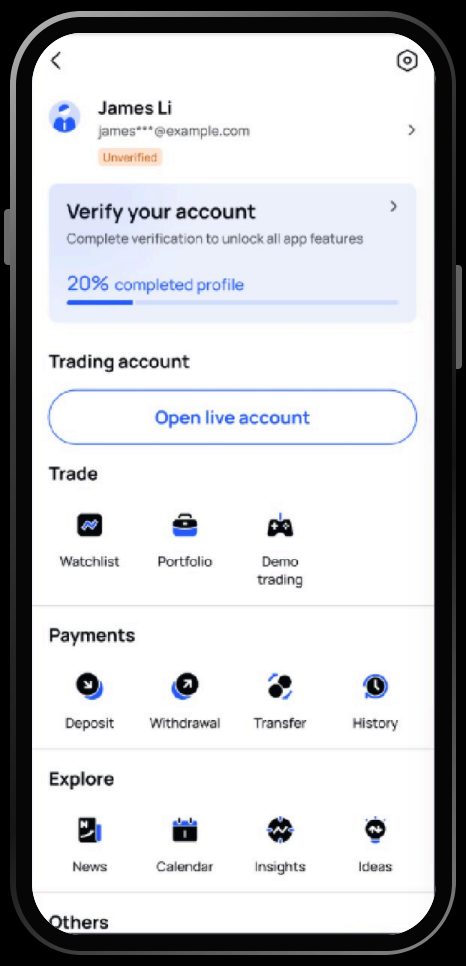
*IT LOOKED SERIOUS. IT ALSO LOOKED LIKE **WORK**.*



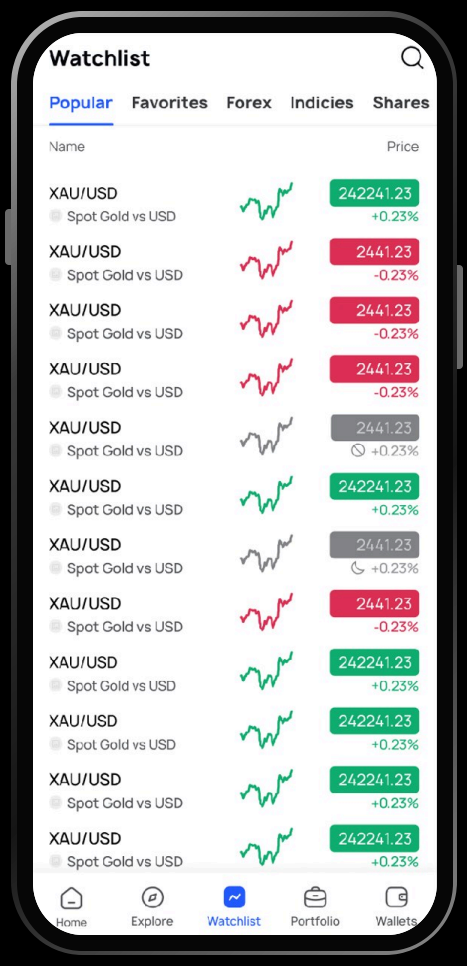

*CONCEPT: TRADE & SIGNALS*




*CONCEPT: CHART DETAIL*




*SHIPPED: GUIDED HOME*




*SHIPPED: WATCHLIST*

## THE DECISION

*WE MOVED FROM A DARK EXPERT TERMINAL TO A **LIGHT, STRUCTURED PRODUCT**.*

## WHAT IT GAVE US

*A GUIDED HOME THAT SURFACES **VERIFICATION AND NEXT STEPS**.*

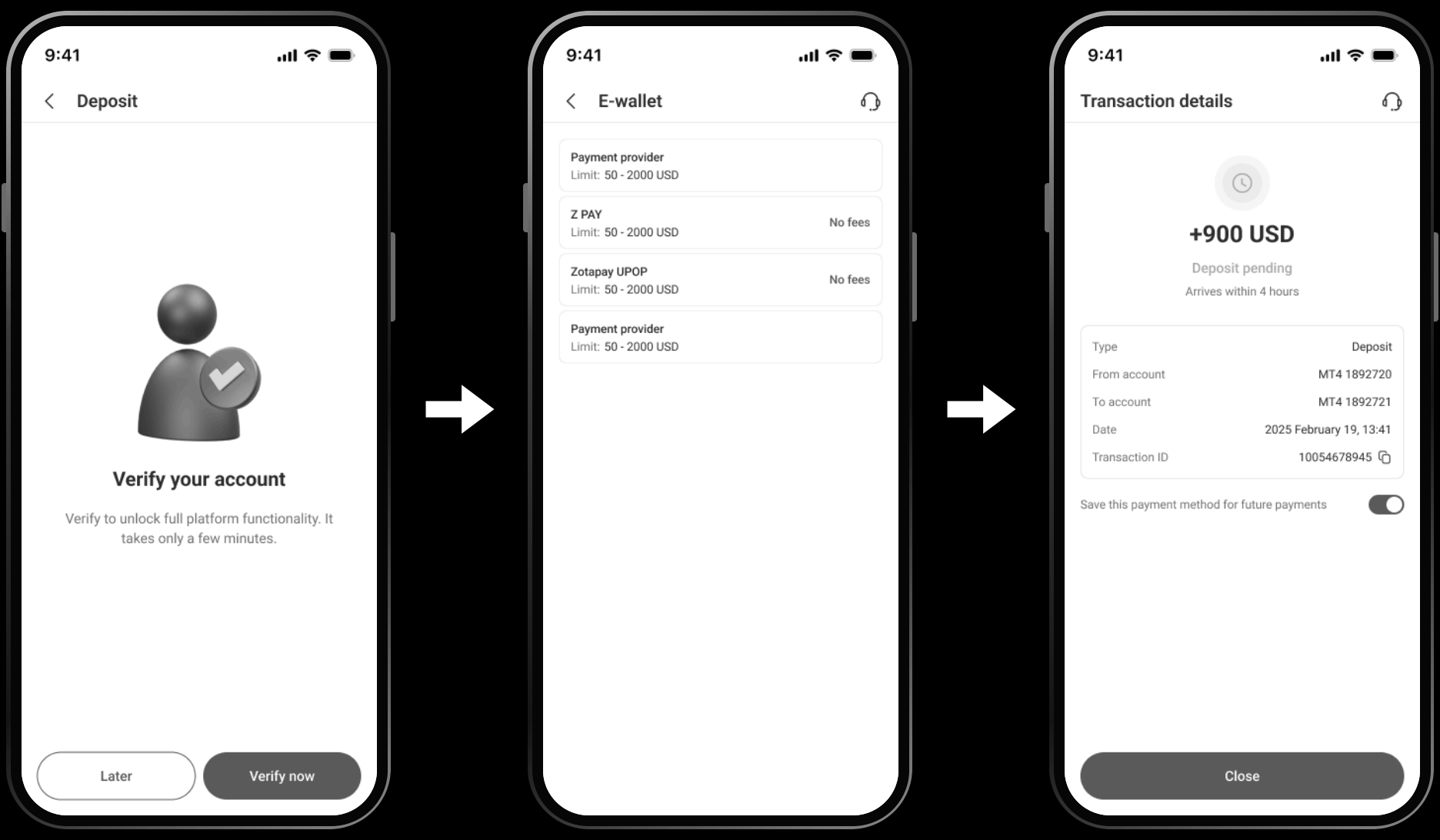
*A **READABLE** WATCHLIST.*

*A PAYMENT FLOW THAT MAKES METHODS AND LIMITS OBVIOUS **BEFORE THE USER COMMITS**.*

# LIMITS FIRST, MONEY SECOND

## THE DECISION

*A PAYMENT FLOW THAT MAKES METHODS AND LIMITS OBVIOUS **BEFORE THE USER COMMITS**.*




*1. THE GATE, SAID OUT LOUD*

*2. LIMITS AND FEES UP FRONT*

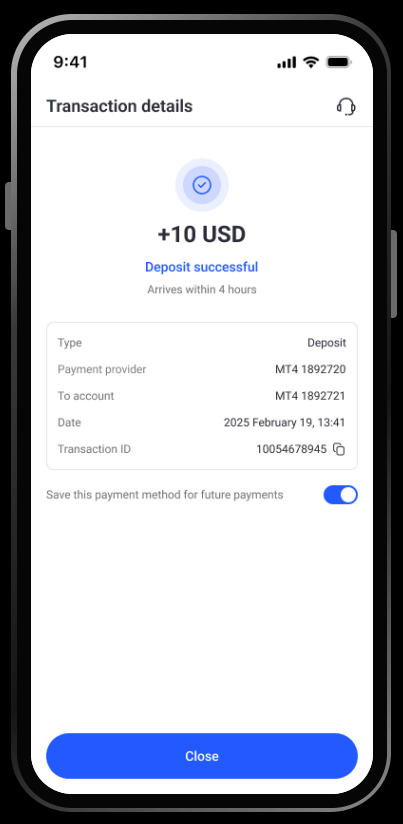
*3. PENDING, WITH TIMING*

## WHAT CHANGED ON THE WAY

*IF VERIFICATION IS REQUIRED, THE FLOW SAYS SO **AT THE DOOR**. "LATER" SITS NEXT TO "VERIFY NOW", AT EQUAL WEIGHT.*

*EACH METHOD SHOWS ITS **LIMIT AND FEES IN THE LIST**, BEFORE ANY AMOUNT IS TYPED.*

*A PENDING DEPOSIT SAYS **WHEN IT ARRIVES**: "ARRIVES WITHIN 4 HOURS". THE TRANSACTION ID IS ONE TAP TO COPY.*




*4. DONE*

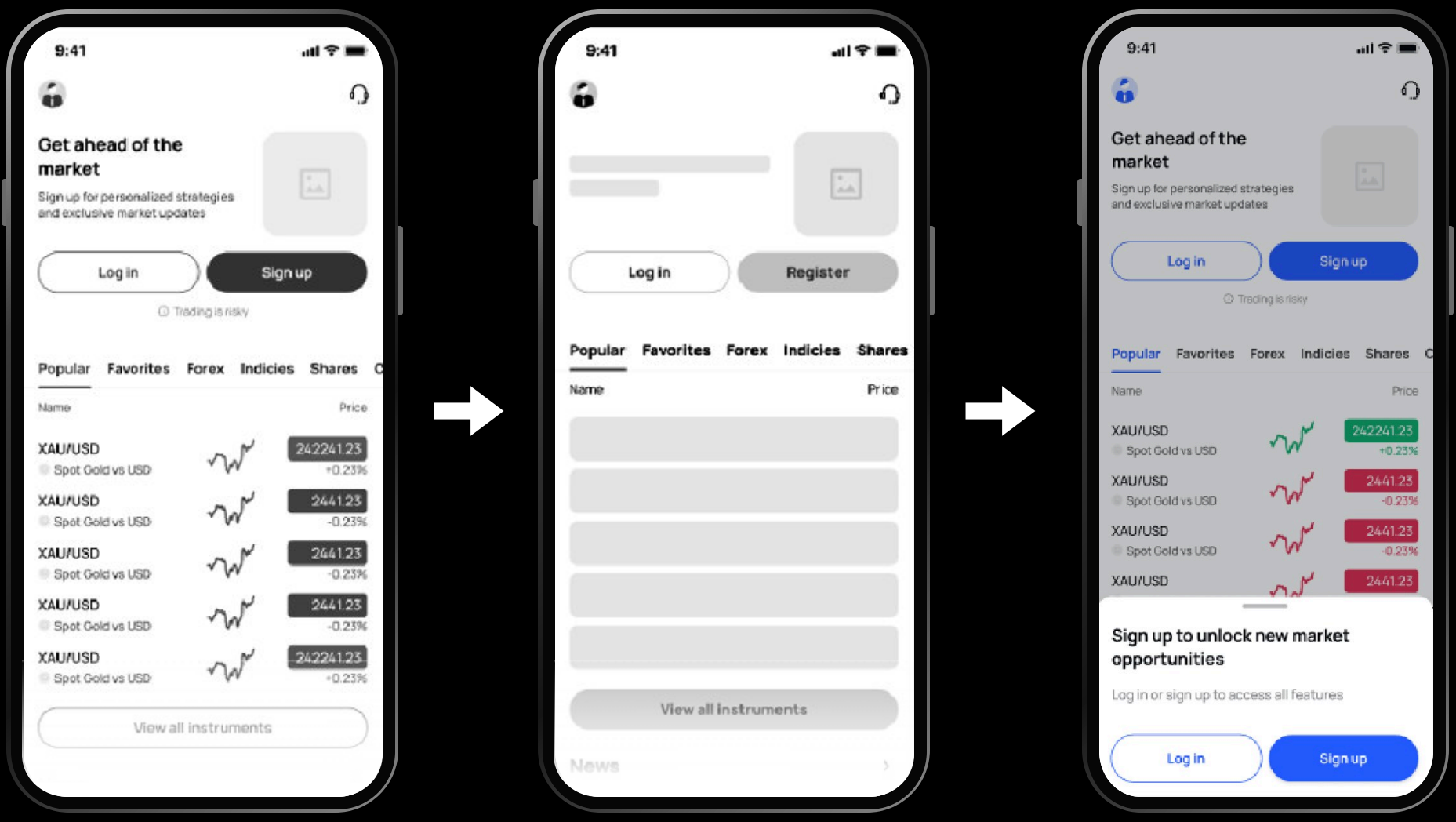
# EXPLORE FIRST, SIGN UP LATER

## THE PROBLEM

*BEFORE, REGISTRATION WAS A **HARD WALL**: THE APP OPENED ON A LOGIN FORM.*

## THE DECISION

*NOW ANYONE CAN **BROWSE LIVE MARKETS, NEWS AND LESSONS FIRST**.*




*1. LIVE MARKET, NO LOGIN*

*2. EVERY STATE WORKS FOR GUESTS*

*3. SIGNUP, WHERE VALUE IS FELT*

## HOW

*EVERY STATE IS DESIGNED FOR GUESTS TOO: SKELETON LOADING, **HONEST ERROR SCREENS WITH A RETRY**, AND EMPTY STATES THAT EXPLAIN WHAT IS COMING.*

*SIGNUP APPEARS EXACTLY **WHERE VALUE IS FELT**: SAVING FAVORITES OR UNLOCKING THE FULL MARKET LIST OPENS A BOTTOM SHEET, NOT A DEAD END.*

## THE RESULT

# THE LARGEST CONVERSION IMPROVEMENT IN THE WHOLE REDESIGN.

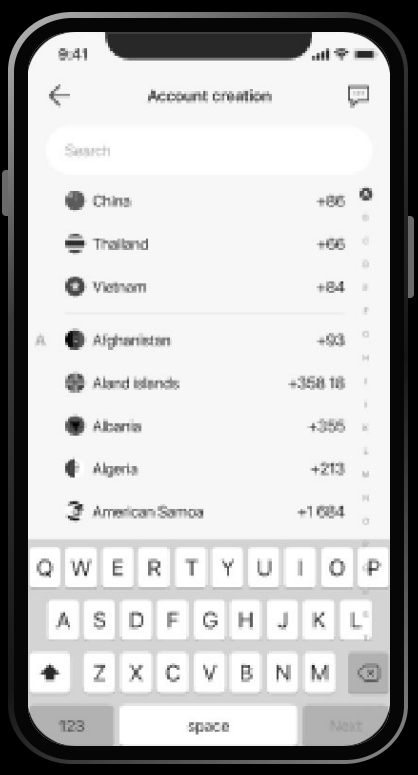
*ONE CHANGE: **TRY THE PRODUCT BEFORE COMMITTING**.*

## THE PATH, BEFORE AND AFTER · FOUND WHILE TESTING

**BEFORE** *OPEN APP → REGISTER → KYC → FINALLY, THE PRODUCT*

**AFTER** *OPEN APP → EXPLORE → AN ACTION THAT NEEDS AN ACCOUNT → SHORT SIGN-UP → ID CHECK*

# ONE THING PER SCREEN



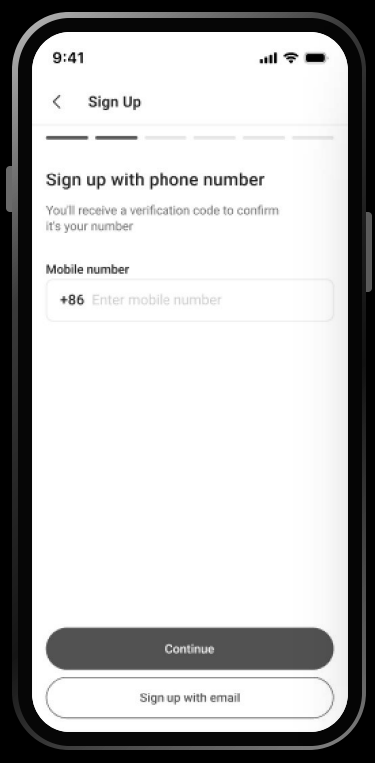

*OLD REGISTRATION*

## THE PROBLEM

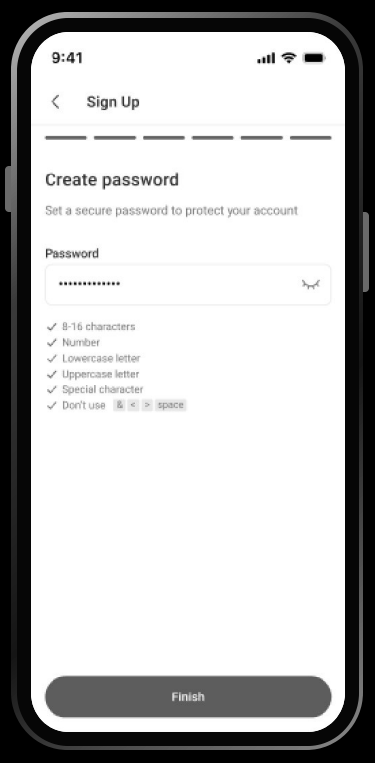
*FRAGMENTED STATES, **OPEN KEYBOARDS** AND UNCLEAR TRANSITIONS.*

## THE DECISION

***SIX FOCUSED STEPS.** EACH SCREEN ASKS FOR ONE KIND OF INFORMATION.*




*NEW: STEP 2, PHONE*



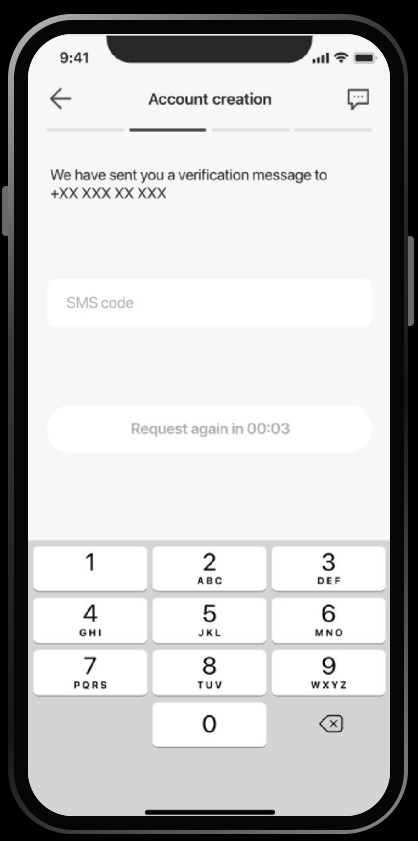

*NEW: STEP 6, PASSWORD*

*A PERSISTENT **PROGRESS INDICATOR** MAKES THE SCOPE OF REGISTRATION VISIBLE FROM THE START.*

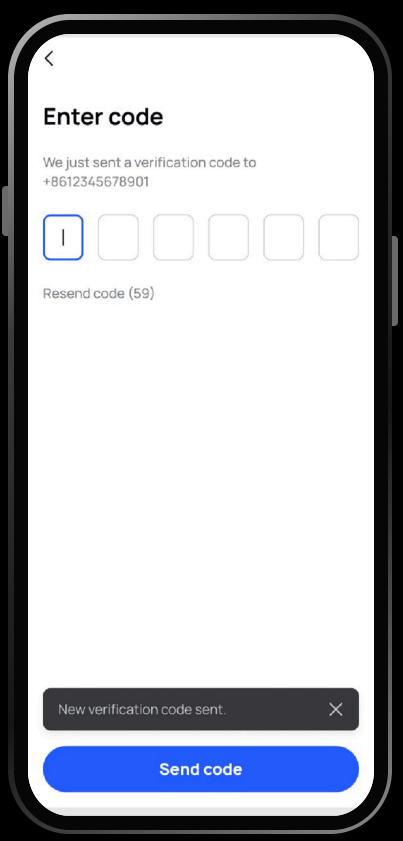
*PHONE AND EMAIL VERIFICATION ARE **SEPARATED AND EXPLAINED** BEFORE THE USER ACTS.*

***PASSWORD REQUIREMENTS ARE VISIBLE UP FRONT**, PREVENTING TRIAL-AND-ERROR AT THE FINAL STEP.*

# SAME RULE, ONE SCREEN DEEPER: THE CODE




*OLD: ONE BLANK FIELD*




*NEW: SIX BOXES*

*THE OLD SCREEN WAS A SINGLE BLANK FIELD WITH **NO FEEDBACK**.*

*SIX SEPARATE BOXES, SO PROGRESS AND ERRORS ARE VISIBLE **PER DIGIT**.*

*THE NUMBER THE CODE WAS SENT TO IS SHOWN IN FULL, SO A TYPO IN THE PHONE STEP IS CAUGHT HERE **INSTEAD OF IN SUPPORT**.*

*RESEND IS ALWAYS PRESENT, WITH A **VISIBLE COUNTDOWN**.*

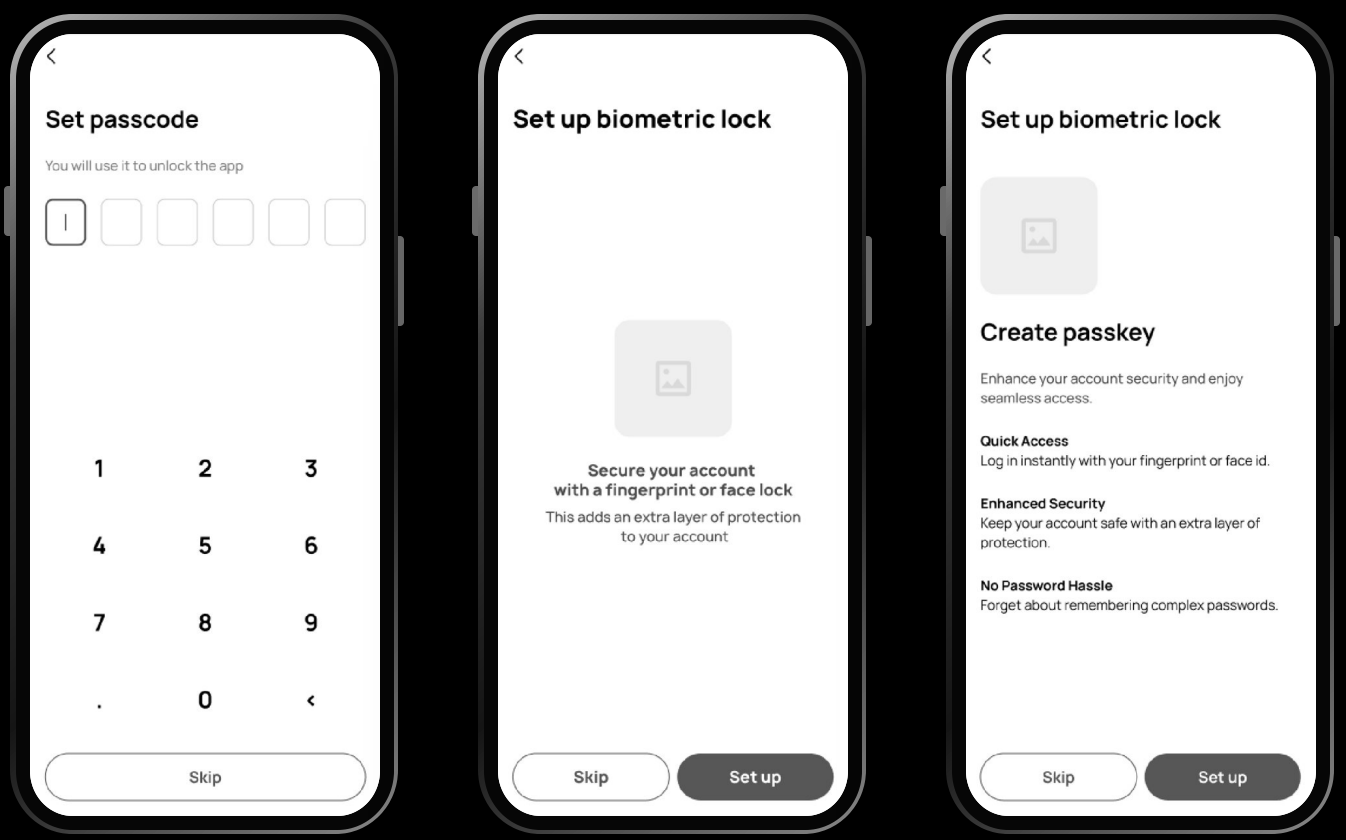
# LOCK THE DOOR. THEN KNOCK.

## THE PROBLEM

*THE OLD APP HAD **NO LOCAL PROTECTION AT ALL**: ANYONE HOLDING THE PHONE COULD OPEN IT AND SEE BALANCES.*

## THE DECISION

*A **SIX-DIGIT PASSCODE** SET DURING ONBOARDING, **BIOMETRIC UNLOCK** RIGHT AFTER, AND A **PASSKEY** OPTION THAT REMOVES PASSWORDS ENTIRELY.*



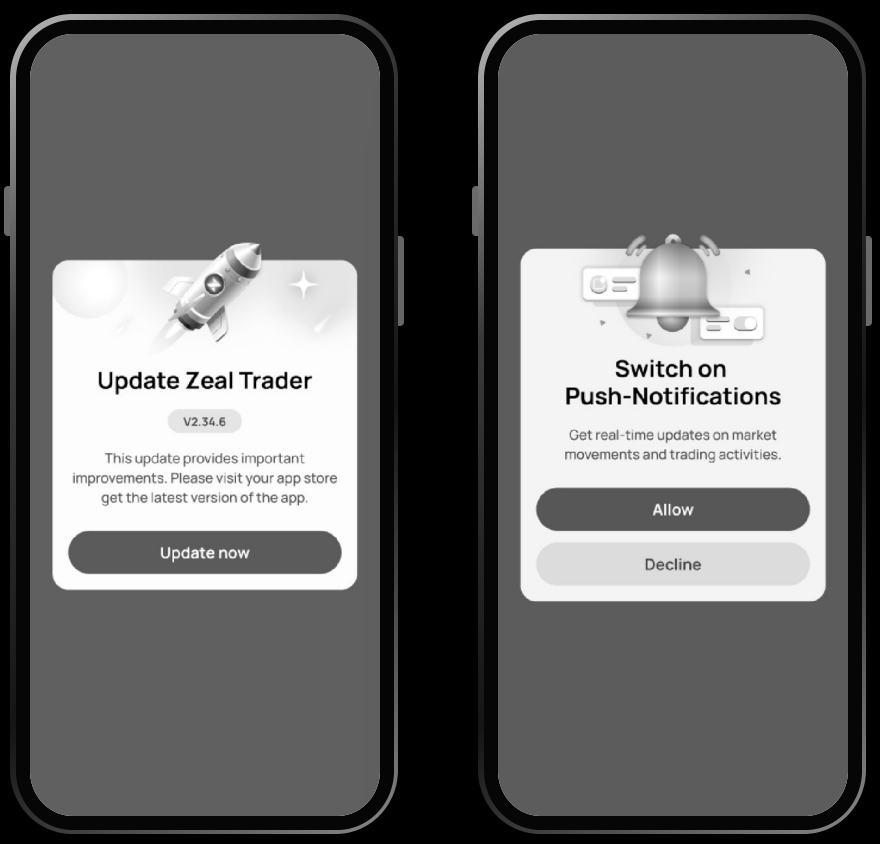

*1. PASSCODE* *2. BIOMETRIC LOCK* *3. PASSKEY*

## THE RULE

***EVERY STEP IS SKIPPABLE.** SECURITY NEVER BLOCKS REGISTRATION.*

*FORGET THE PASSCODE? YOU SIMPLY LOG IN AGAIN.*

# THEN KNOCK: POPUPS THAT ASK HONESTLY



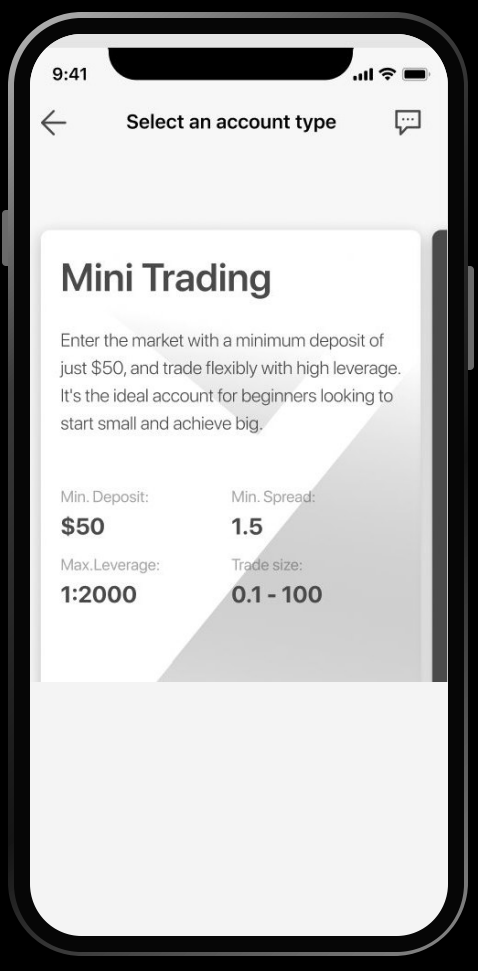

*FORCE UPDATE* *PUSH NOTIFICATIONS*

*THE OLD APP HAD NONE OF THESE SYSTEM DIALOGS. UPDATES, NOTIFICATIONS AND TRACKING HAPPENED **SILENTLY OR NOT AT ALL**.*

*FORCE AND SOFT UPDATES EXPLAIN THE VERSION AND THE REASON, SO A BLOCKED SCREEN **NEVER FEELS LIKE A BUG**.*

*PUSH AND ADS-TRACKING ASKS STATE THE VALUE FIRST, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE, WITH **ALLOW AND DECLINE GIVEN EQUAL WEIGHT**.*

# COMPARE, DON'T REMEMBER

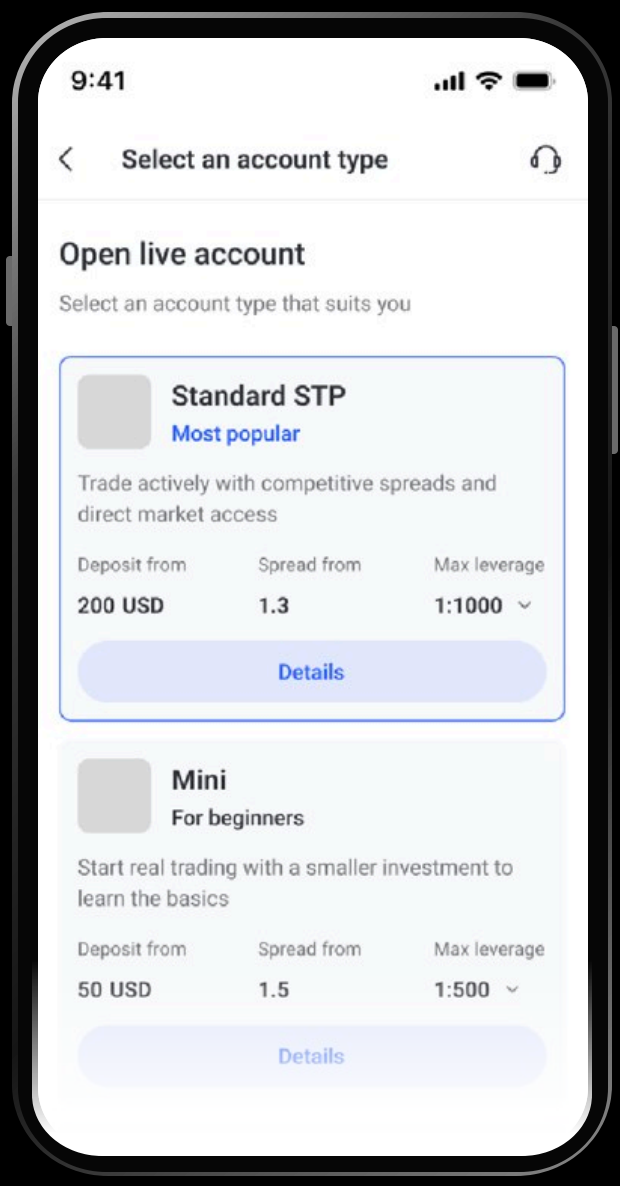



*OLD: A CAROUSEL*

## THE PROBLEM

*A HORIZONTAL CAROUSEL **HID ALTERNATIVES** AND MADE USERS COMPARE ACCOUNTS FROM MEMORY.*

*THE CARDS DESCRIBED FEATURES, BUT NOT **WHO EACH ACCOUNT WAS FOR**.*




*NEW: EVERYTHING ON ONE PAGE*

## THE DECISION

*ALL ACCOUNT TYPES ARE **VISIBLE ON ONE PAGE**, SO COMPARISON IS IMMEDIATE.*

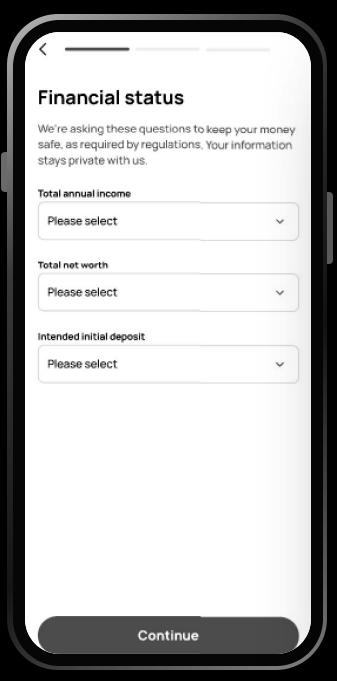
*EACH OPTION STATES ITS AUDIENCE: **MOST POPULAR, FOR BEGINNERS, OR FOR PROFESSIONALS**.*

*DEPOSIT, SPREAD AND LEVERAGE USE THE **SAME STRUCTURE** ACROSS EVERY ACCOUNT.*

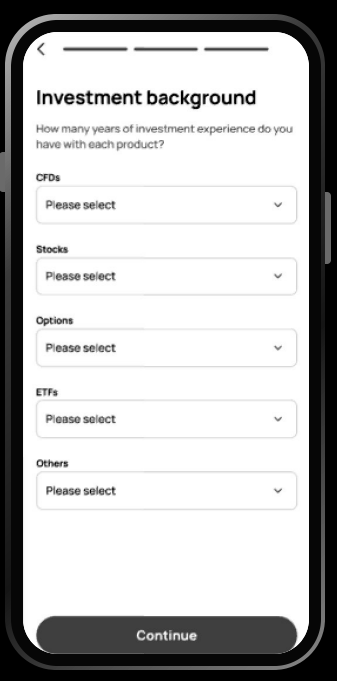
*ONE **RECOMMENDED OPTION** REDUCES UNCERTAINTY WITHOUT REMOVING USER CHOICE.*

## SAME RULE, HARDER FORM

*THE FINANCIAL ASSESSMENT WAS SPLIT INTO FOCUSED STEPS: **ONE TOPIC PER STEP**, A VISIBLE PROGRESS INDICATOR, AND PLAIN-LANGUAGE CONTEXT FOR WHY SENSITIVE INFORMATION IS REQUIRED.*




*FINANCIAL STATUS*




*INVESTMENT BACKGROUND*

# ONE DOOR FOR EVERYONE

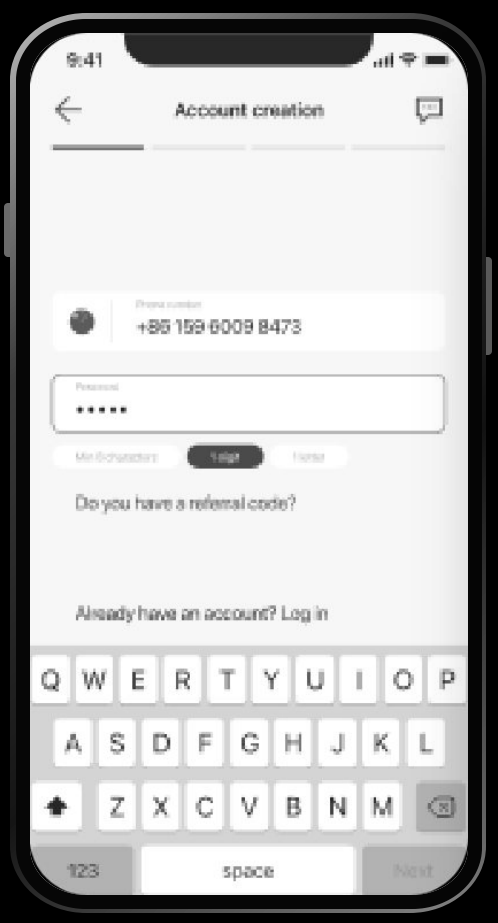
## THE PROBLEM

*ONE REGISTRATION AND ONE KYC FOR **EVERYONE**: RETAIL TRADERS, LARGE INVESTORS, EVERY COUNTRY. DIFFERENT RULES, THE SAME PATH.*

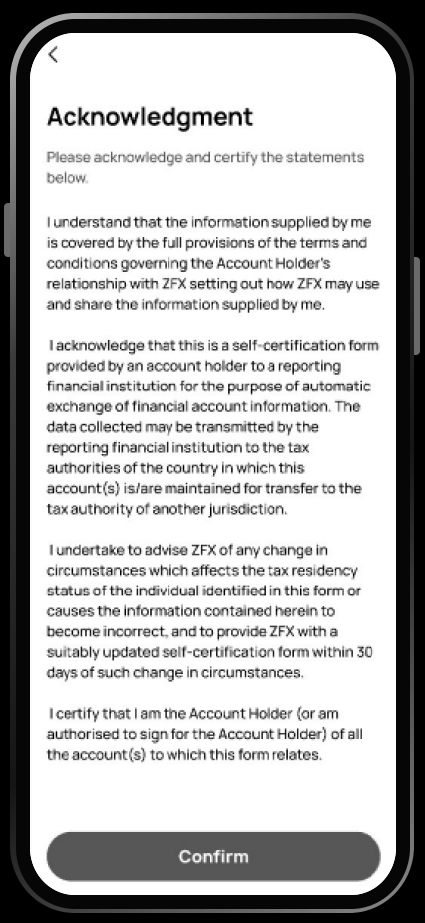
*FIELDS, DOCUMENTS AND CONFIRMATIONS SHOWED UP **WHETHER OR NOT THIS USER NEEDED THEM**. TOO MUCH WAS ASKED TOO EARLY.*

*AND THE PRODUCT STAYED LOCKED UNTIL ALL OF IT WAS DONE. **THE VALUE CAME LAST.***

***HYPOTHESIS:** ONE UNIVERSAL KYC AND AN OVERLOADED SIGN-UP WERE LOSING CLIENTS BEFORE THEY EVER USED THE PRODUCT.*




*OLD: ONE FORM FOR ALL*




*A WALL OF CHECKBOXES*

# STEP ONE: ASK THE DATA

WITH THE ANALYTICS TEAM

| 01 | 02 | 03 | 04 | 05 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| *COUNTRIES AND REGIONS* | *CLIENT CATEGORIES* | *RETAIL TRADERS VS LARGE INVESTORS* | *KYC RULES PER SEGMENT* | *WHO NEEDS ENHANCED ID* |

## WHAT WE FOUND

*THE PRODUCT SERVED AUDIENCES WITH **DIFFERENT NEEDS AND LEGAL LIMITS** THROUGH ONE SHARED PATH.*

*USERS FROM CHINA COULD NEED **EXTRA PHONE AND IDENTITY DATA**. FOR SOME CATEGORIES ELSEWHERE, THE SAME FIELDS WEREN'T MANDATORY.*

## THE DECISION

*SPLIT THE AUDIENCE BY **CATEGORY AND JURISDICTION**. DESIGN SEVERAL FITTING SCENARIOS, NOT ONE UNIVERSAL KYC.*

*THE SEGMENTS CAME FROM **DATA**, NOT FROM OUR GUESSES.*



# SAME APP, DIFFERENT PATHS

HOW THE SIGN-UP DECIDES WHAT TO ASK

**1 COUNTRY**
*WHAT WE KNOW ABOUT THE USER'S COUNTRY AND ITS REGULATORY CONTEXT.*

→

**2 SCENARIO**
*PICK THE REGISTRATION AND ID SCENARIO THAT APPLIES.*

→

**3 FIELD SET**
*BUILD ONLY THE FIELDS AND CONFIRMATIONS IT NEEDS.*

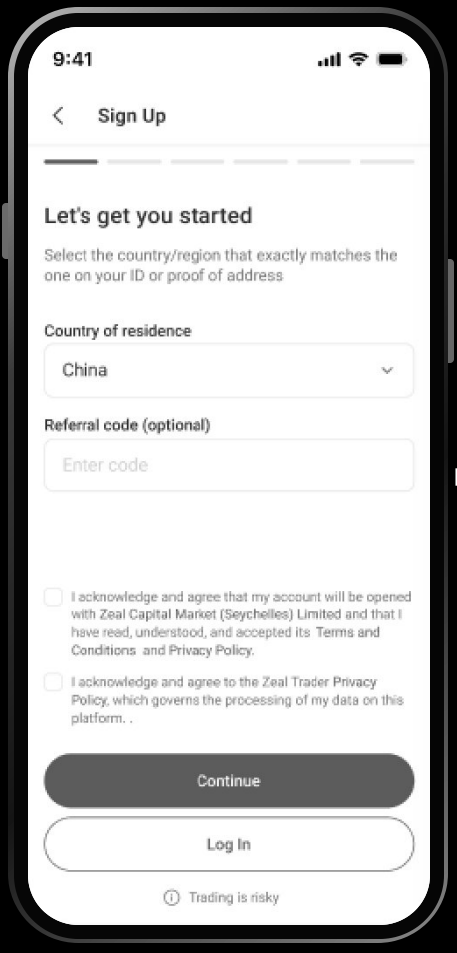
→

**4 NOW**
*SHOW ONLY WHAT MATTERS AT THIS STEP, FOR THIS CLIENT.*

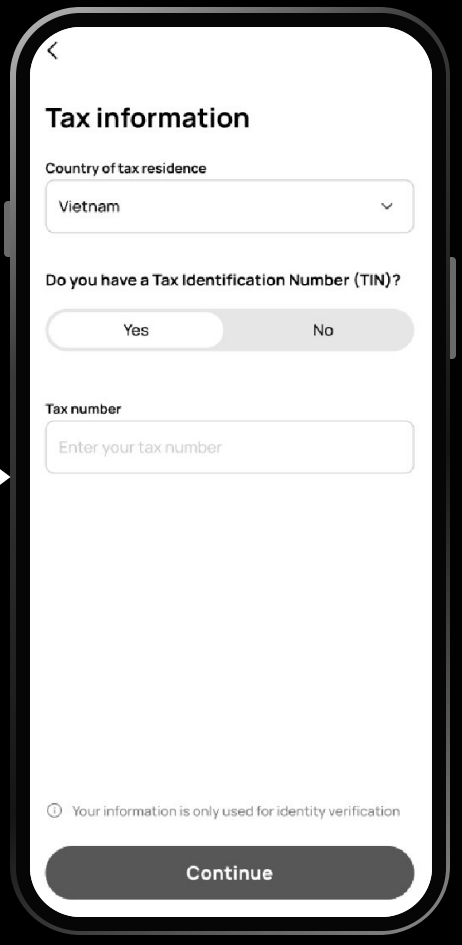
**BASIC INFO IS ENOUGH**
*A SHORT FORM. NOTHING ELSE UP FRONT.*

**COUNTRY NEEDS MORE**
*EXTRA FIELDS SWITCH ON FOR THAT COUNTRY OR CATEGORY.*

**DOCS FOR SOME TOOLS**
*ASKED AT THE STEP THAT NEEDS THEM, NOT AT THE DOOR.*




*COUNTRY FIRST: IT PICKS THE PATH*




*A FIELD THAT DEPENDS ON THE COUNTRY*

THE RESULT

*NO MORE ONE PATH FOR EVERYONE.* ***ADAPTIVE LOGIC****, BUILT ON AUDIENCE NEEDS AND REGULATORY LIMITS.*

*THE RULES DIDN'T GET SOFTER. THE SIGN-UP JUST* ***STOPPED ASKING EVERYONE EVERYTHING****.*

*EVERY BRANCH WAS SPECIFIED FOR ENGINEERING:* ***SEE PAGE 33****.*



*SAME RULES. DIFFERENT ORDER, DIFFERENT AMOUNT,* ***DEPENDING ON WHO YOU ARE****.*

# ASK LATER, NOT LESS

THE COMPLIANCE AUDIT: SIX QUESTIONS

1. *WHAT PERSONAL DATA IS REQUIRED AT FIRST SIGN-UP?*
2. *WHICH DOCUMENTS DOES KYC ACTUALLY NEED?*
3. *WHAT DEPENDS ON THE JURISDICTION?*
4. *WHAT DIFFERS BY CLIENT CATEGORY?*
5. *WHAT CAN WAIT UNTIL A SPECIFIC FINANCIAL FEATURE?*
6. *WHICH FIELDS, CONFIRMATIONS AND CHECKBOXES CAN LEAVE THE FIRST STEP?*

*THE GOAL WASN'T FEWER FIELDS. IT WAS **THE RIGHT FIELD AT THE RIGHT STEP.***

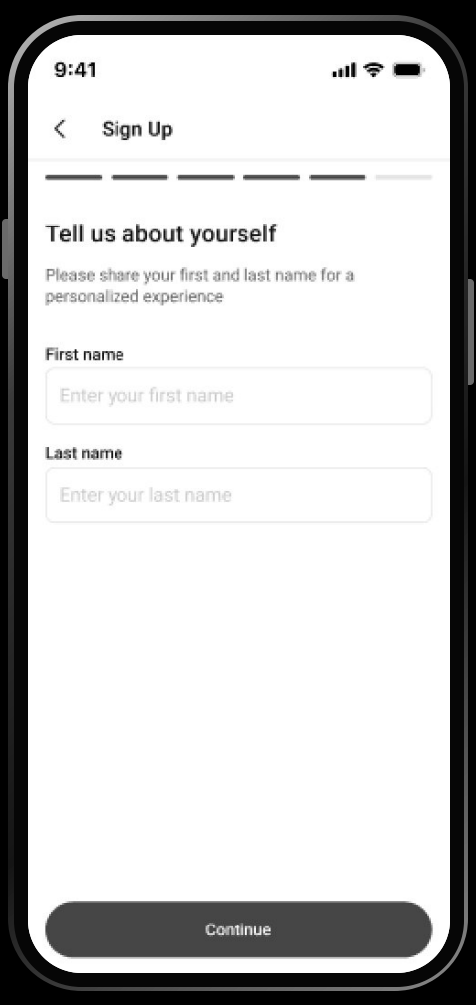
***WAS:** THE FULL SET OF FIELDS, WHETHER YOU NEEDED THEM NOW OR NOT.*

***BECAME:** IF A FIELD ISN'T REQUIRED FOR THIS SCENARIO AT THIS STEP, IT ISN'T ON THE SCREEN.*

## NOTHING WAS CANCELLED. WE MOVED WHEN IT IS ASKED.

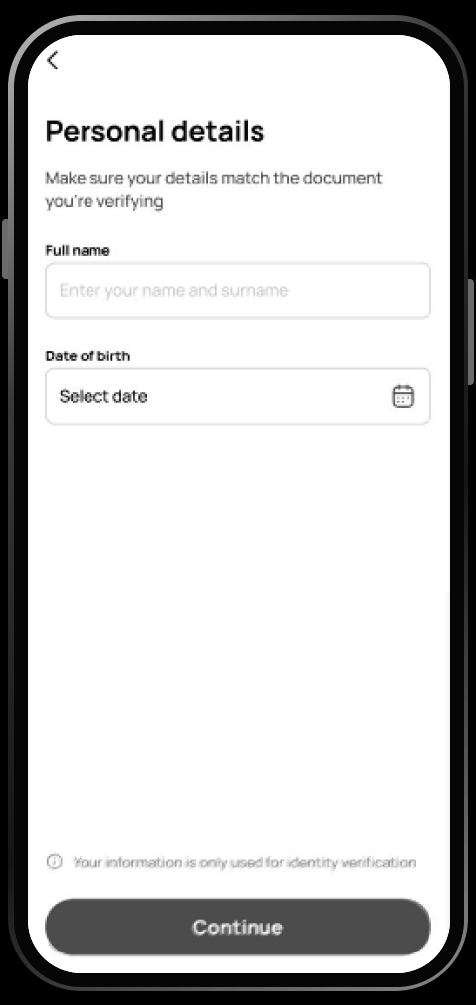
THE ORDER, READ FROM THE SHIPPED SCREENS

### 1 SIGN UP




*WHO YOU ARE, HOW TO REACH YOU*

### 2 PROFILE




*DETAILS THE REGULATOR NEEDS*

### 3 BEFORE MONEY MOVES




*DOCUMENTS, GATED AT THE DEPOSIT (PAGE 13)*

***RESULT:** LESS ASKED UP FRONT, AND EVERY COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENT KEPT.*

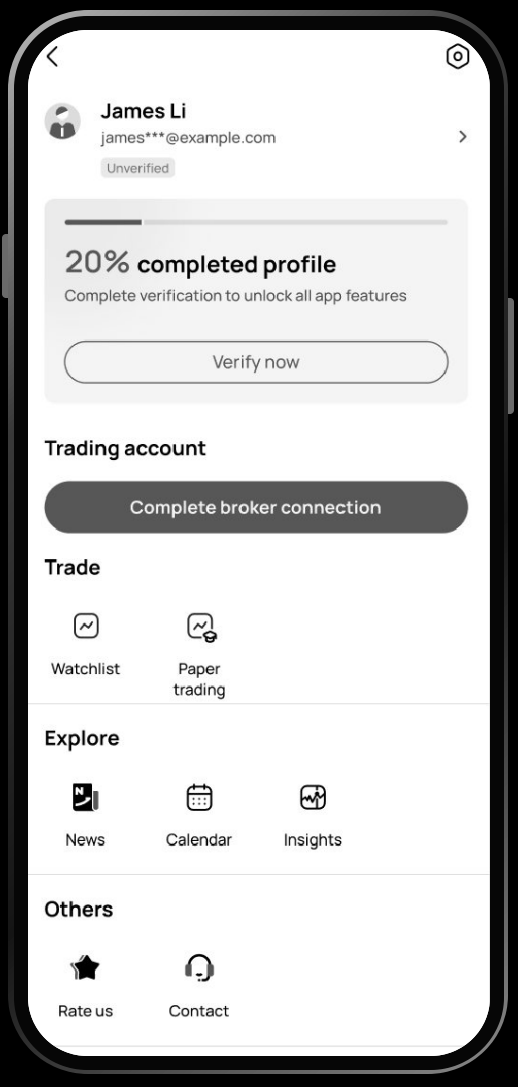
# A REASON TO FINISH

## THE PROBLEM

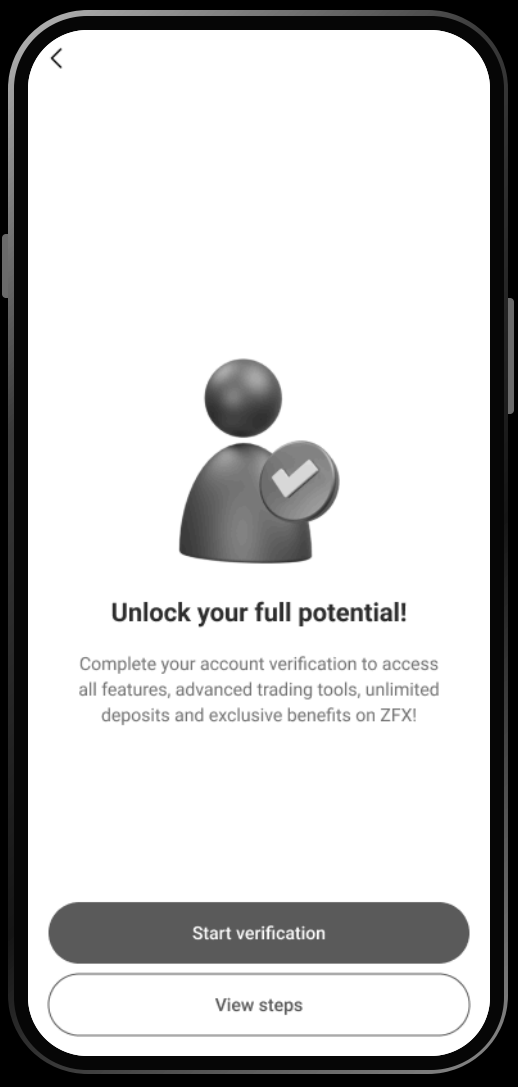
*REGISTRATION READ AS **A LIST OF OBLIGATIONS**. NOTHING ON THE SCREEN SAID WHAT YOU GET FOR FINISHING.*

## THE DECISION

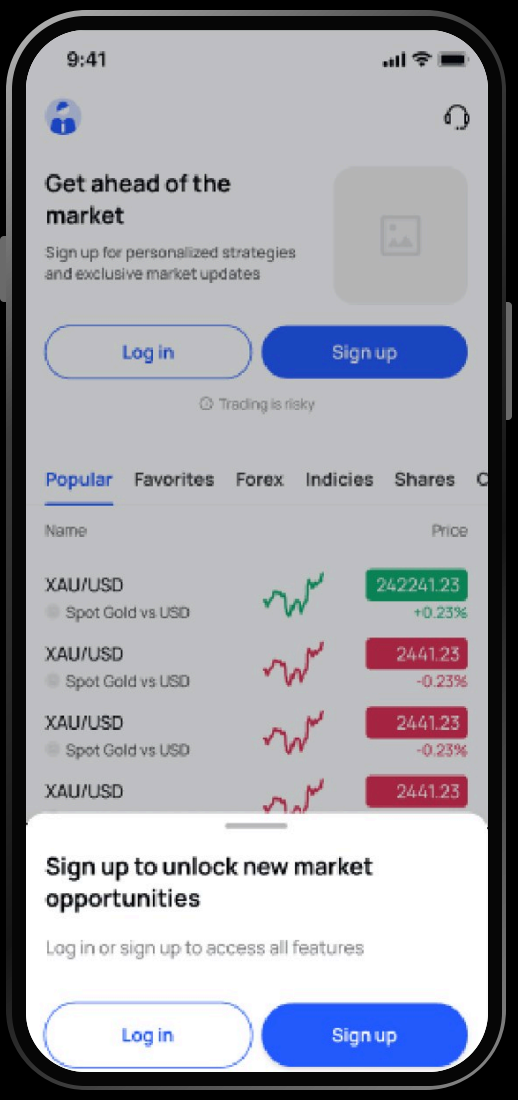
*TURN SIGN-UP FROM BUREAUCRACY INTO **A CLEAR STEP TOWARD VALUE**.*




*PROGRESS YOU CAN SEE: 20% DONE*




*THE BENEFIT NAMED BEFORE THE STEPS*




*ASKED AT THE MOMENT OF VALUE*

## WHAT WE WORKED THROUGH

*WHAT A **FINISHED REGISTRATION** GIVES YOU, SAID PLAINLY.*

*PRODUCT VALUE MADE **VISIBLE**, NOT HIDDEN BEHIND THE FORMS.*

*SHORT **MOTIVATING MESSAGES** INSIDE THE ONBOARDING ITSELF.*

*SHORT, CLEAR COPY ABOUT **WHAT'S LEFT TO DO**.*

## OFFERS ON THE TABLE

**CASH BONUS**

**COMMISSION-FREE PERIOD**

**SIGN UP IN ABOUT 30 SECONDS**

*DISCUSSED FOR NEW CLIENTS. **THE FINAL OFFER ISN'T ON RECORD**, SO IT ISN'T CLAIMED HERE.*

*A FORM ASKS. A PRODUCT **OFFERS**. WE WANTED THE SCREEN TO DO THE SECOND.*



# ~~100+~~ → 17

## WHAT WE FOUND

*THE SYSTEM GENERATED MORE THAN **100 TECHNICAL AND OPERATIONAL REJECTION CODES**, SPREAD ACROSS DOCUMENT TYPES, COUNTRIES, VERIFICATION PROVIDERS, COMPLIANCE SCENARIOS AND PAYMENT CHECKS.*

*FROM A USER PERSPECTIVE, MANY OF THEM MEANT **THE SAME THING**.*

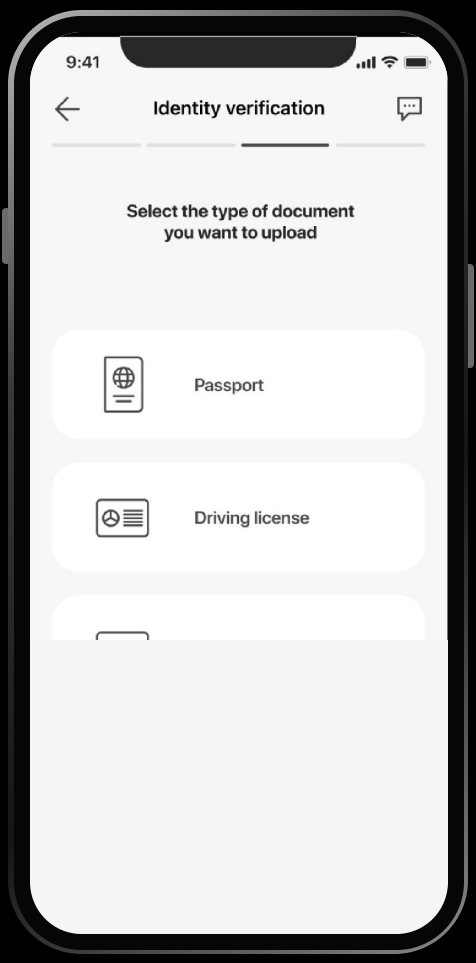
## HOW WE GOT TO 17

***1.** 30+ USER INTERVIEWS INFORMED THE ONBOARDING AND KYC REDESIGN.*

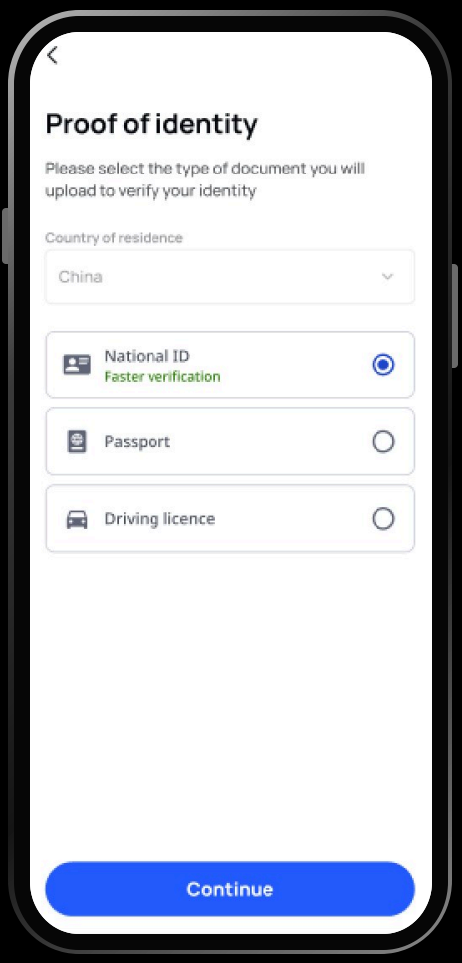
***2.** AUDITED EVERY REJECTION CODE IN THE VERIFICATION JOURNEY AND MAPPED IT TO THE **ACTUAL USER PROBLEM** BEHIND IT.*

***3.** IDENTIFIED OVERLAPS AND DUPLICATES, AND COLLAPSED THEM.*

***4.** FOR EVERY FINAL REASON: A CLEAR EXPLANATION PLUS **ONE RECOVERY ACTION** THE USER CAN TAKE.*




*OLD KYC*




*REWORKED: CLEARER REQUIREMENTS*

*AN AUDIT, NOT A CLEANUP. THE WORK BECAME AN **ABSTRACTION LAYER** BETWEEN COMPLIANCE LOGIC AND THE PERSON.*



# ONE PROBLEM, FIVE NAMES

*NOBODY DESIGNED 100+ REJECTION REASONS. THEY ACCUMULATED, BECAUSE **FIVE DIFFERENT SOURCES** EACH REPORTED FAILURE IN THEIR OWN VOCABULARY.*

## DOCUMENT TYPES x COUNTRIES x VERIFICATION PROVIDERS x COMPLIANCE SCENARIOS x PAYMENT CHECKS

EXAMPLE: THE PHOTO IS BLURRY

*VERIFICATION PROVIDER A SAYS* `OCR_CONFIDENCE_LOW`

*VERIFICATION PROVIDER B SAYS* `IMG_QUALITY_FAIL`

*THE BACK OFFICE SAYS* `DOC_UNREADABLE`

*A COMPLIANCE RULE SAYS* `POA_ILLEGIBLE`

*A PAYMENT CHECK SAYS* `CARD_PHOTO_UNCLEAR`

THE USER SEES ONE

*02 · DOCUMENT IS UNREADABLE / BLURRY*

*RETAKE THE PHOTO*

*FROM A USER PERSPECTIVE, MANY OF THEM MEANT **THE SAME THING**.*

*FIVE TEAMS, FIVE WORDS FOR **"I CAN'T READ THIS"**. THE USER ONLY NEEDS ONE. AND A BUTTON.*



# THE AUDIT, PASS BY PASS

## 1 COLLECT

*EVERY REJECTION CODE IN THE VERIFICATION JOURNEY GOES INTO **ONE TABLE**: VENDOR RESPONSES, BACK-OFFICE STATUSES, COMPLIANCE RULES, PAYMENT CHECKS.*

100+ CODES

## 2 TRANSLATE

*ONE QUESTION PER ROW: WHAT IS THE **ACTUAL USER PROBLEM** BEHIND THIS CODE?*

USER PROBLEMS

## 3 MERGE

*OVERLAPS AND DUPLICATES COLLAPSE. DIFFERENT CODES, SAME USER PROBLEM, **SAME ROW**.*

MERGED

## 4 SPLIT BY WHO CAN ACT

***USER CAN FIX IT**, OR USER CAN'T. VENDOR TIMEOUTS, LOW OCR CONFIDENCE, AML RULES AND MANUAL REVIEW NEVER BECOME A USER-FACING REASON.*

CAN FIX | CAN'T

## 5 WRITE

*FOR EVERY FINAL REASON: A PLAIN-LANGUAGE EXPLANATION PLUS **ONE RECOVERY ACTION** THE USER CAN TAKE.*

17

## 6 CHECK

*30+ USER INTERVIEWS INFORMED THE ONBOARDING AND KYC REDESIGN. THE FLOWS WERE **VALIDATED WITH USABILITY TESTING**.*

TESTED



*PASS ONE WAS THE LEAST GLAMOROUS PART OF THE PROJECT: **A VERY LONG SPREADSHEET**.*

# WHAT FOLDED INTO WHAT

CODE NAMES ARE REBUILT FROM MEMORY, NOT THE PRODUCTION ONES. THE 17 REASONS ON THE LEFT ARE THE REAL LIST.

| WHAT THE USER READS | CODES THAT FOLDED INTO IT | THE ONE ACTION |
|---|---|---|
| 01 *DOCUMENT HAS EXPIRED* | DOC_EXPIRED · ID_EXPIRY_PAST · PASSPORT_EXPIRED · DL_EXPIRED · EXPIRY_LT_30D · RESIDENCE_PERMIT_EXPIRED | *UPLOAD A VALID DOCUMENT* |
| 02 *DOCUMENT IS UNREADABLE / BLURRY* | IMG_BLURRY · OCR_CONFIDENCE_LOW · GLARE_DETECTED · LOW_RESOLUTION · MRZ_UNREADABLE · PHOTO_TOO_DARK | *RETAKE THE PHOTO* |
| 03 *WRONG DOCUMENT TYPE* | DOC_TYPE_UNSUPPORTED · DOC_TYPE_MISMATCH · NOT_GOV_ISSUED · STUDENT_ID_SUBMITTED · PHOTOCOPY_NOT_ACCEPTED · SCREENSHOT_SUBMITTED | *CHOOSE ANOTHER DOCUMENT* |
| 04 *MISSING PAGE OR INCOMPLETE DOCUMENT* | BACK_SIDE_MISSING · PAGE_MISSING · CORNERS_CUT_OFF · DOC_PARTIALLY_COVERED · ONLY_ONE_SIDE · MULTIPLE_DOCS_IN_FRAME | *UPLOAD THE MISSING SIDE* |
| 05 *NAME DOESN'T MATCH THE ACCOUNT* | NAME_MISMATCH · FIRST_LAST_SWAPPED · MIDDLE_NAME_MISSING · TRANSLITERATION_DIFF · MAIDEN_NAME · NAME_TYPO_PROFILE | *FIX THE NAME OR UPLOAD ANOTHER DOCUMENT* |
| 06 *DATE OF BIRTH DOESN'T MATCH* | DOB_MISMATCH · DOB_FORMAT_DD_MM · DOB_OCR_DIFF · AGE_CALC_MISMATCH · DOB_PROFILE_TYPO | *CORRECT THE DATE OF BIRTH* |
| 07 *COUNTRY OR NATIONALITY MISMATCH* | COUNTRY_MISMATCH · NATIONALITY_DIFF · ISSUING_COUNTRY_UNSUPPORTED · RESIDENCE_NOT_PROVEN · DOC_COUNTRY_NEQ_PROFILE | *CONFIRM YOUR COUNTRY* |
| 08 *PROOF OF ADDRESS IS TOO OLD* | POA_OLDER_3M · POA_OLDER_6M · POA_DATE_MISSING · POA_DATE_UNREADABLE · STATEMENT_PERIOD_OLD | *UPLOAD A RECENT DOCUMENT* |
| 09 *ADDRESS DOESN'T MATCH THE PROFILE* | ADDRESS_MISMATCH · POSTCODE_DIFF · PO_BOX_ADDRESS · ADDRESS_INCOMPLETE · POA_OTHER_PERSON · CITY_MISMATCH | *UPDATE THE ADDRESS OR UPLOAD ANOTHER PROOF* |



*THE TEST FOR EVERY ROW: COULD THE USER **DO THE SAME THING** TO FIX IT? SAME FIX, SAME REASON.*

# AND THE OTHER EIGHT

| WHAT THE USER READS | CODES THAT FOLDED INTO IT | THE ONE ACTION |
|---|---|---|
| **10** *UNSUPPORTED PROOF OF ADDRESS* | POA_TYPE_UNSUPPORTED · INSURANCE_LETTER · RENTAL_CONTRACT · ENVELOPE_PHOTO · POA_NOT_OFFICIAL · ONLINE_ORDER_RECEIPT | *SEE ACCEPTED DOCUMENTS* |
| **11** *BANK HOLDER NAME MISMATCH* | BANK_NAME_MISMATCH · THIRD_PARTY_ACCOUNT · JOINT_ACCOUNT · CARD_HOLDER_DIFF · COMPANY_ACCOUNT · EWALLET_NAME_DIFF | *USE AN ACCOUNT IN YOUR NAME* |
| **12** *BANK STATEMENT INVALID OR OUTDATED* | STATEMENT_OUTDATED · STATEMENT_NO_NAME · STATEMENT_NO_ACCOUNT_NO · STATEMENT_CROPPED · STATEMENT_NOT_OFFICIAL · IBAN_UNREADABLE | *UPLOAD A RECENT STATEMENT* |
| **13** *DOCUMENT ALREADY IN USE* | DOC_DUPLICATE · DOC_LINKED_OTHER_ACCOUNT · DUPLICATE_PROFILE · DOC_NUMBER_REUSED · SAME_SELFIE_OTHER_ACC | *LOG IN TO THE EXISTING ACCOUNT* |
| **14** *DOCUMENT LOOKS ALTERED* | TAMPERING_SUSPECTED · FONT_INCONSISTENT · PHOTO_REPLACED · DIGITAL_EDIT_DETECTED · HOLOGRAM_MISSING · MRZ_CHECKSUM_FAIL | *UPLOAD THE ORIGINAL DOCUMENT* |
| **15** *SELFIE VERIFICATION FAILED* | LIVENESS_FAILED · FACE_MISMATCH · FACE_NOT_DETECTED · MULTIPLE_FACES · EYES_CLOSED_OR_COVERED · SELFIE_TOO_DARK | *RETAKE THE SELFIE* |
| **16** *NEEDS MANUAL REVIEW* | MANUAL_REVIEW_REQUIRED · VENDOR_INCONCLUSIVE · LOW_MATCH_SCORE · EDD_REQUIRED · PEP_POTENTIAL_MATCH · NAME_SCREENING_HIT | *NOTHING TO DO: WE'RE REVIEWING* |
| **17** *OTHER: CONTACT SUPPORT* | UNKNOWN_ERROR · UNMAPPED_VENDOR_CODE · UNDERAGE · RESTRICTED_JURISDICTION · ACCOUNT_BLOCKED · LEGACY_STATUS | *CONTACT SUPPORT* |

THE BUCKET WITH NO NUMBER

## NEVER SHOWN AS A REASON

VENDOR_TIMEOUT · VENDOR_5XX · OCR_SERVICE_DOWN · QUEUE_DELAYED · AML_RULE_PENDING · SANCTIONS_CHECK_RUNNING · WEBHOOK_LOST · RETRY_SCHEDULED · UPLOAD_FAILED_NETWORK · FILE_TOO_LARGE

*"WE'RE REVIEWING YOUR DOCUMENTS"*

*THESE ARE **OUR** PROBLEMS, NOT THE USER'S. THEY GET A CALM STATUS AND A RETRY ON OUR SIDE, NEVER A REJECTION.*

*ROW 17 IS THE SAFETY NET: ANYTHING UNMAPPED LANDS WITH **A HUMAN**, NOT ON A BLANK ERROR.*

# THE 17

ONE TAXONOMY. EVERY REASON A USER CAN ACTUALLY SEE.

01 *DOCUMENT HAS EXPIRED*

02 *DOCUMENT IS UNREADABLE / BLURRY*

03 *WRONG DOCUMENT TYPE*

04 *MISSING PAGE / INCOMPLETE DOCUMENT*

05 *NAME DOESN'T MATCH ACCOUNT*

06 *DATE OF BIRTH DOESN'T MATCH*

07 *COUNTRY / NATIONALITY MISMATCH*

08 *PROOF OF ADDRESS TOO OLD*

09 *ADDRESS DOESN'T MATCH PROFILE*

10 *UNSUPPORTED PROOF OF ADDRESS*

11 *BANK HOLDER NAME MISMATCH*

12 *BANK STATEMENT INVALID / OUTDATED*

13 *DOCUMENT ALREADY IN USE*

14 *DOCUMENT LOOKS ALTERED*

15 *SELFIE VERIFICATION FAILED*

16 *NEEDS MANUAL REVIEW*

17 *OTHER: CONTACT SUPPORT*

*EVERY REASON SHIPS WITH A **PLAIN-LANGUAGE EXPLANATION** AND **ONE CLEAR RECOVERY ACTION**.*



# NO SLOT OF THEIR OWN

*SEVENTEEN IS A SMALL NUMBER. THESE ARE THE CASES SOMEONE ALWAYS ASKS ABOUT:* ***"WHERE DID THAT ONE GO?"***

## FOLDED INTO ONE OF THE 17

***GLARE, REFLECTIONS, CUT CORNERS.*** *STILL A PHOTO PROBLEM.* **02 · 04**

***PHOTOCOPY, SCREENSHOT, BLACK-AND-WHITE SCAN.*** *NOT AN ORIGINAL.* **03**

***THE FACE DOESN'T MATCH THE DOCUMENT.*** *SAME FIX AS A FAILED SELFIE.* **15**

***TYPED DETAILS DIFFER FROM THE DOCUMENT.*** *A TYPO, NOT FRAUD.* **05 · 06**

***PROOF OF ADDRESS IN SOMEONE ELSE'S NAME.*** **09**

***EXTRA DOCUMENTS OR SOURCE OF FUNDS REQUESTED.*** **16**

***UNDERAGE APPLICANT.*** *NO SELF-SERVICE FIX EXISTS.* **17**

## NEVER A REJECTION AT ALL

***RESTRICTED COUNTRY.***

*STOPPED AT REGISTRATION WITH AN HONEST MODAL, BEFORE ANY DOCUMENT IS UPLOADED.*

***FILE TOO LARGE, UPLOAD FAILED.***

*HANDLED AT THE UPLOAD STEP, ON THE SPOT.*

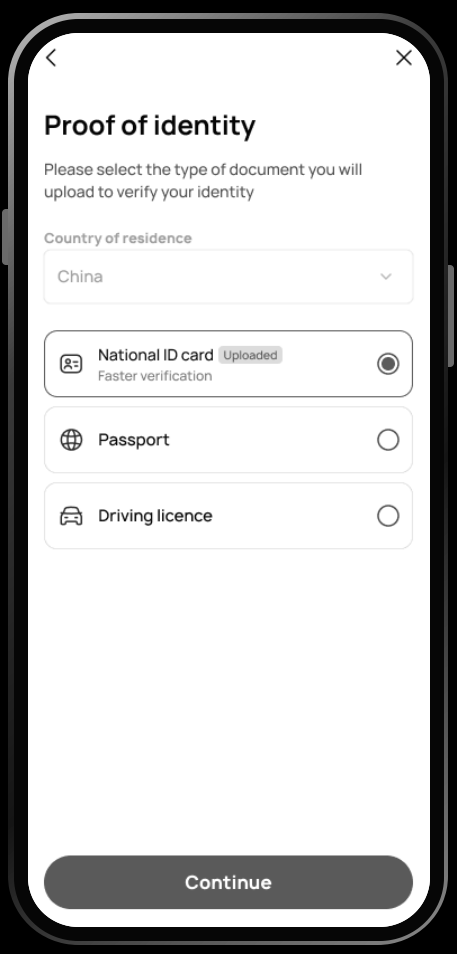
***VENDOR TIMEOUT, OCR DOWN, QUEUE DELAY.***

*HIDDEN BEHIND "WE'RE REVIEWING YOUR DOCUMENTS".*

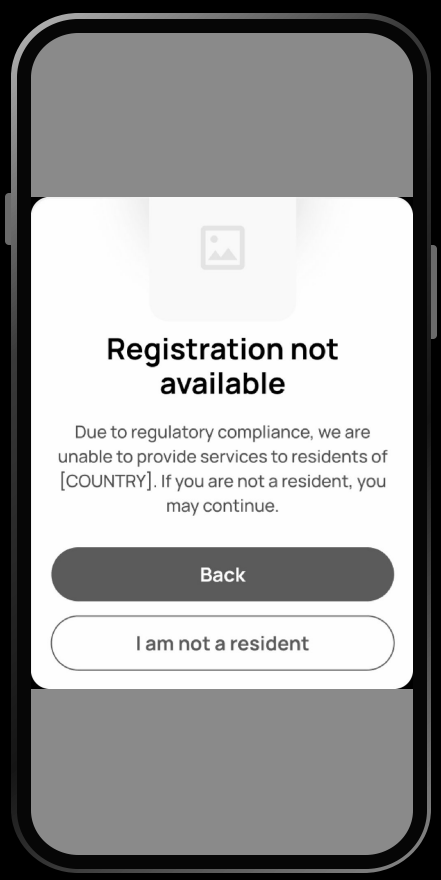
***SANCTIONS AND PEP SCREENING.***

*NEVER USER-FACING. IT SURFACES ONLY AS MANUAL REVIEW.*

*IF THE USER CAN'T ACT ON IT, IT ISN'T A REJECTION REASON.* ***IT'S A STATUS.***




*CAUGHT AT THE FORM, NOT AFTER IT*



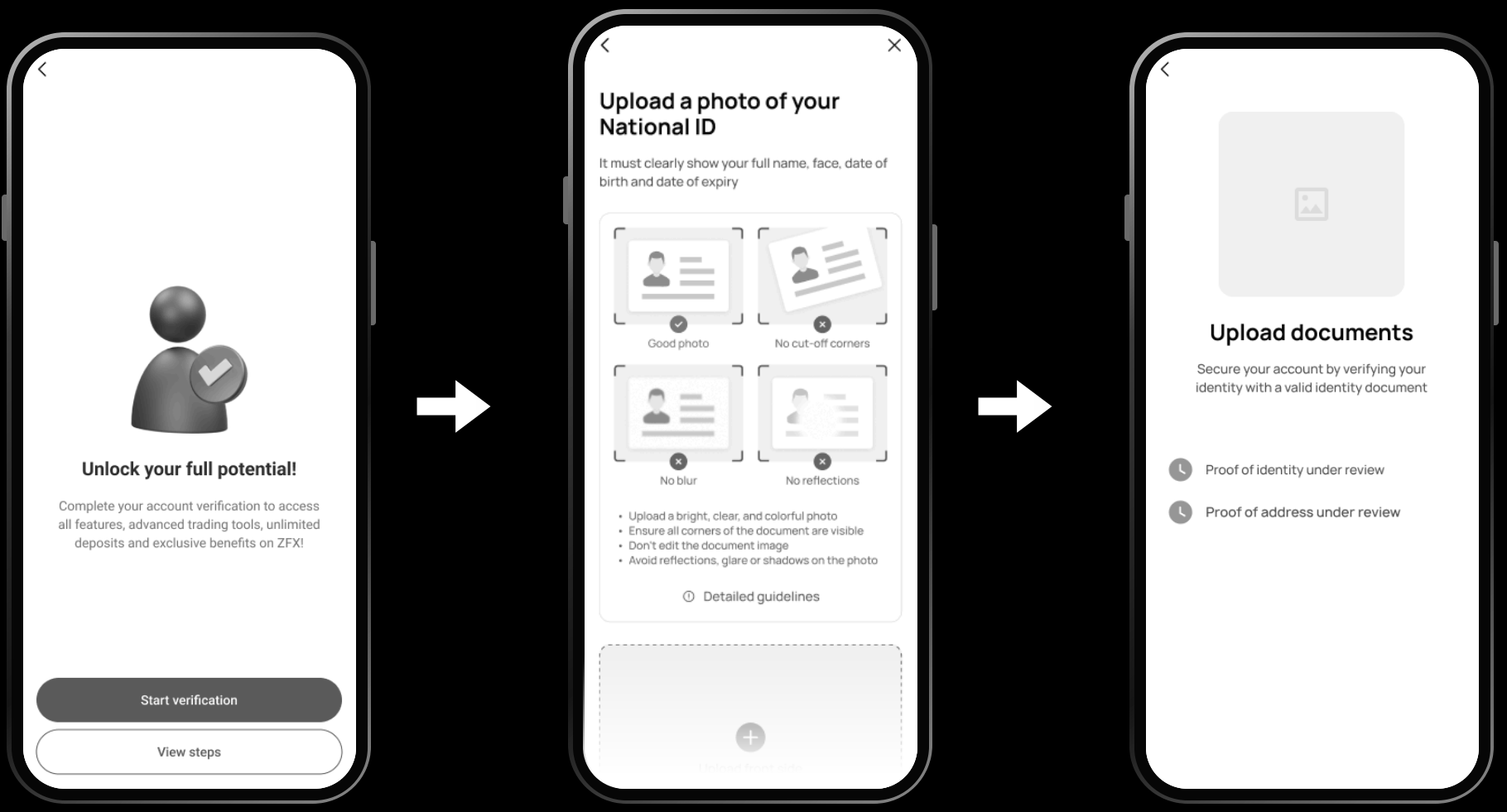

*STOPPED AT THE DOOR, SAID PLAINLY*

*A SHORT LIST IS ONLY HONEST IF YOU CAN SAY* ***WHERE EVERY DROPPED CASE WENT.***



# KYC, DOOR TO BADGE

FIVE SCREENS. WHAT THE 17 REASONS LOOK LIKE FROM THE USER'S SIDE.




## 1 ENTRY

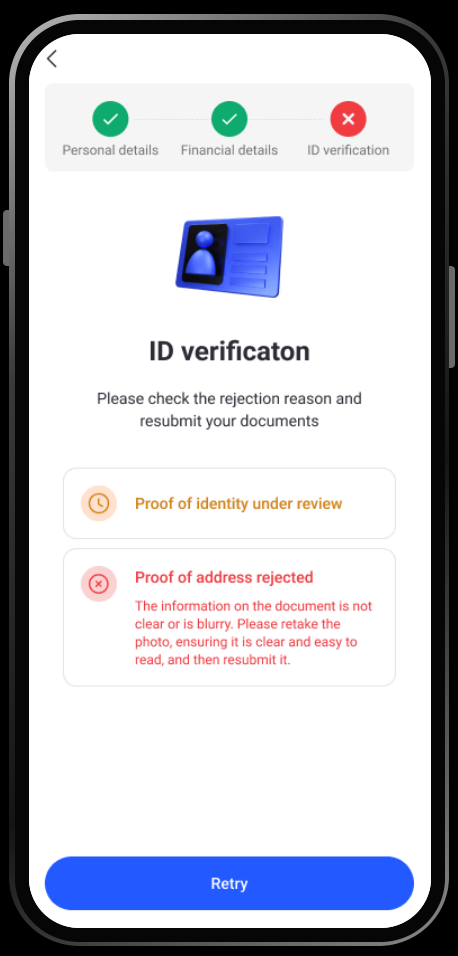
*THE BENEFIT FIRST, THEN TWO CHOICES: **START**, OR VIEW THE STEPS BEFORE COMMITTING.*

## 2 UPLOAD

*GOOD AND BAD PHOTO EXAMPLES SIT **ABOVE THE UPLOAD BUTTON**, NOT IN A HELP ARTICLE.*

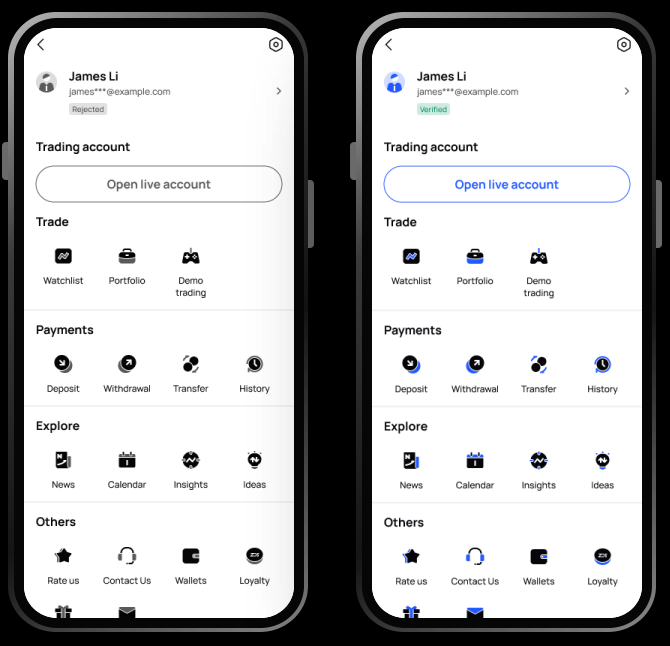
## 3 WAITING

*EACH DOCUMENT CARRIES **ITS OWN STATUS**. NOTHING IS ONE BIG "PENDING".*




## 4 REJECTED

*ONLY THE FAILED DOCUMENT IS FLAGGED, WITH **THE REASON** AND ONE BUTTON: **RETRY**.*

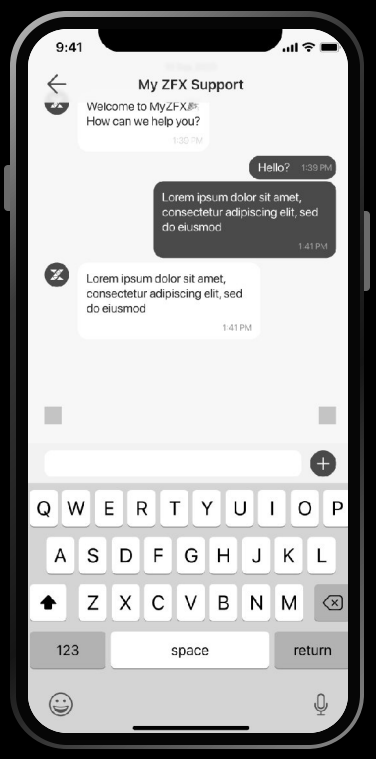



## 5 BADGE

*THE STATUS LIVES ON HOME, UNDER THE NAME: **REJECTED** UNTIL FIXED, THEN **VERIFIED**.*

# A REJECTION YOU CAN ACT ON

## BEFORE



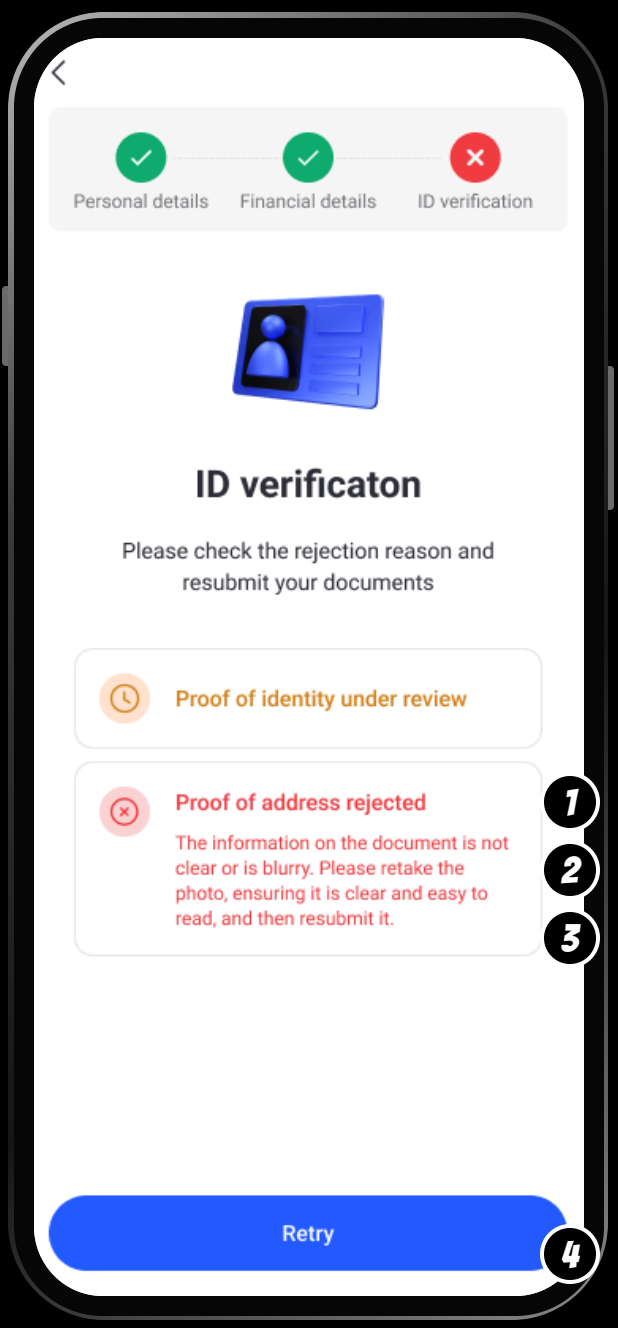

*VERIFICATION FAILED.*

*AND NOTHING ELSE. EVERYTHING ELSE WENT THROUGH A **SUPPORT CHAT**.*

### THE DECISION

*EVERY REJECTION ANSWERS FOUR QUESTIONS ON ONE SCREEN: **WHAT HAPPENED, WHY, HOW TO FIX IT, AND WHERE TO TAP**.*

## AFTER




### NOT EVERY FAILURE IS THE USER'S FAULT

***USER CAN FIX IT:** SHOW THE SPECIFIC REASON AND THE ACTION. WHICH DOCUMENT, WHAT REQUIREMENT, ONE BUTTON TO RETRY.*

***USER CAN'T FIX IT:** VENDOR TIMEOUT, LOW OCR CONFIDENCE, AML RULES, MANUAL REVIEW. NONE OF THAT IS USER-FACING. THEY SEE "WE'RE REVIEWING YOUR DOCUMENTS" OR A SUPPORT PATH.*

### 1 · WHAT HAPPENED

*"PROOF OF ADDRESS **REJECTED**." THE OTHER DOCUMENT KEEPS ITS OWN STATUS.*

### 2 · WHY

*"THE INFORMATION ON THE DOCUMENT IS **NOT CLEAR OR IS BLURRY**."*

### 3 · HOW TO FIX

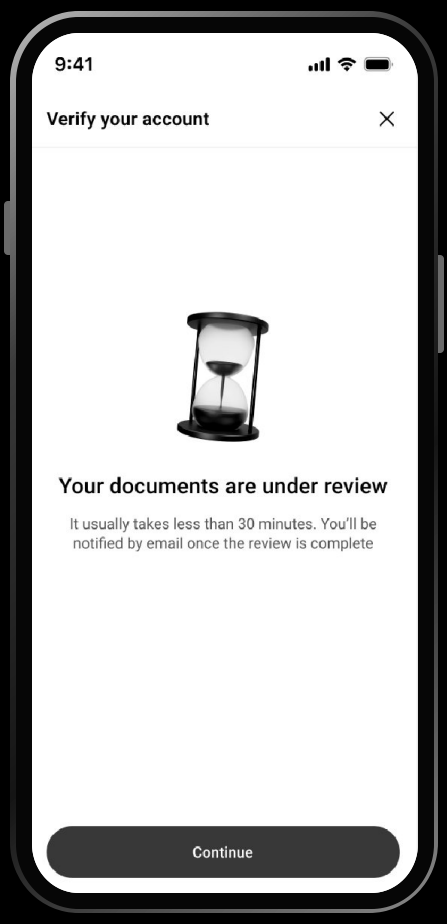
*"PLEASE **RETAKE THE PHOTO**, ENSURING IT IS CLEAR AND EASY TO READ, AND THEN RESUBMIT IT."*

### 4 · ONE BUTTON

*RETRY*

# NO DEAD ENDS

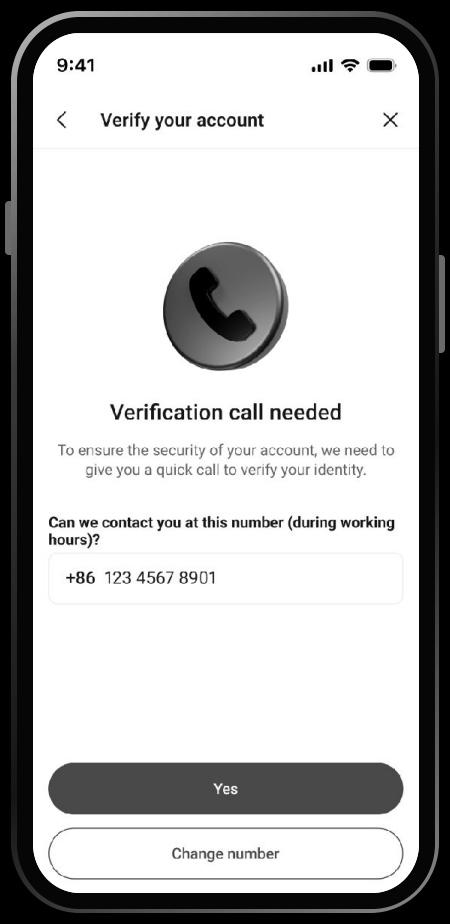
THE RULE: EVERY STATE SAYS WHAT IS HAPPENING AND WHAT COMES NEXT.




REVIEW STATUS

**1**

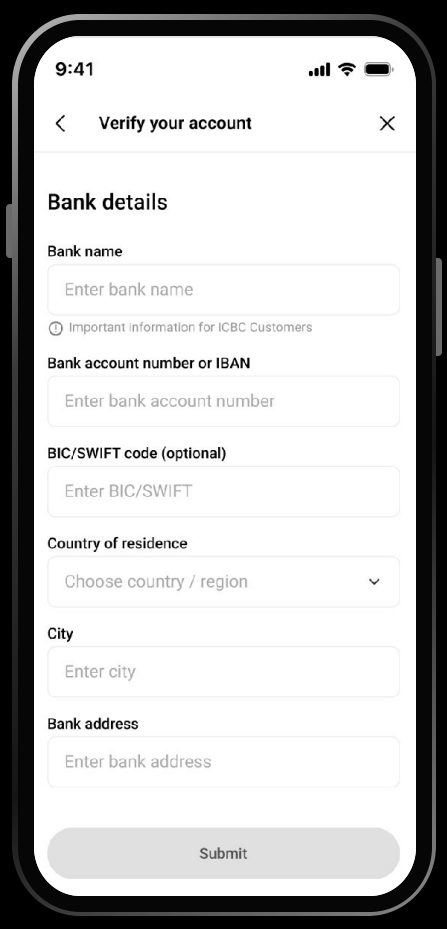
*EVERY WAITING STATE EXPLAINS WHAT IS HAPPENING AND **SETS AN EXPECTATION FOR TIMING**.*




CALL REQUESTED

**2**

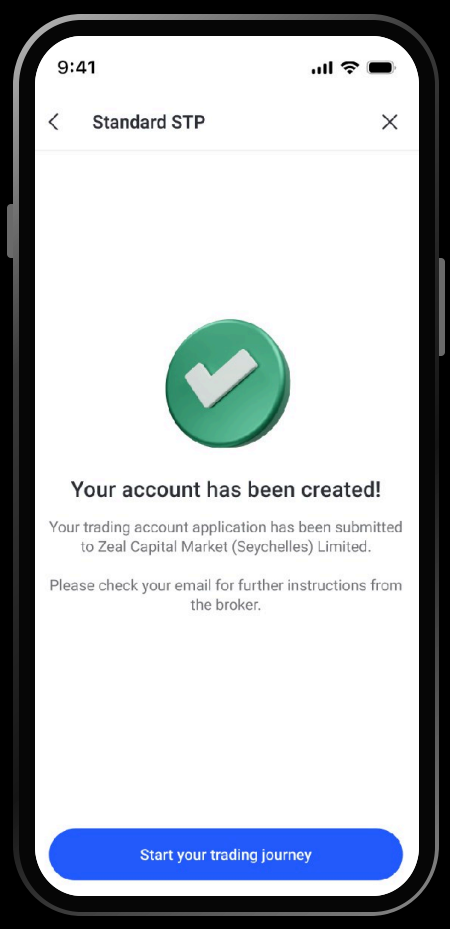
*A VERIFICATION CALL BECOMES A **GUIDED STEP**: CONFIRM THE NUMBER, THEN RECEIVE A CLEAR CALLBACK STATE.*




BANK DETAILS

**3**

*BANK DETAILS ARE COLLECTED IN **ONE STRUCTURED FORM**, WITH CONTEXTUAL GUIDANCE WHERE IT MATTERS.*




ACCOUNT CREATED

**4**

*EACH COMPLETED STEP **CONFIRMS SUCCESS** AND POINTS TO THE NEXT ACTION.*

# ONE SYSTEM, EVERY STATE

***ZEAL DESIGN SYSTEM:*** *SCALABLE COMPONENTS KEEPING WEB, MOBILE AND PWA CONSISTENT. A COMPONENT IS NOT DONE UNTIL ITS UNHAPPY STATES ARE.*

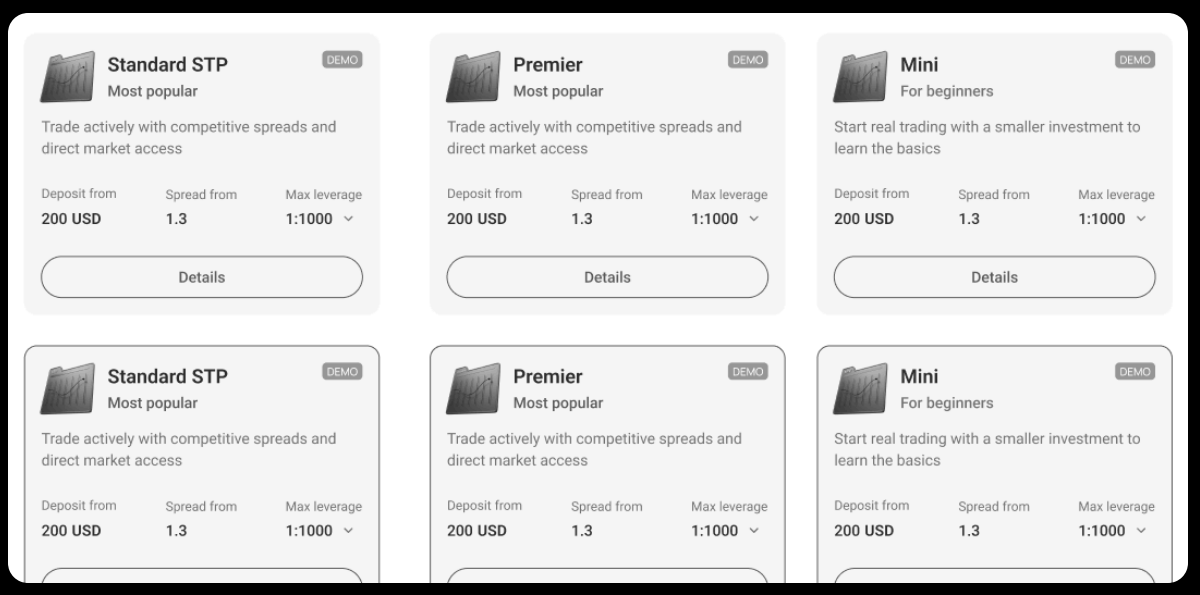
## COMPONENT: CHART SCREEN · FIVE STATES




*MARKET CLOSED* *ACCOUNT DISABLED* *TRADING UNAVAILABLE* *VIEW-ONLY ACCOUNT*

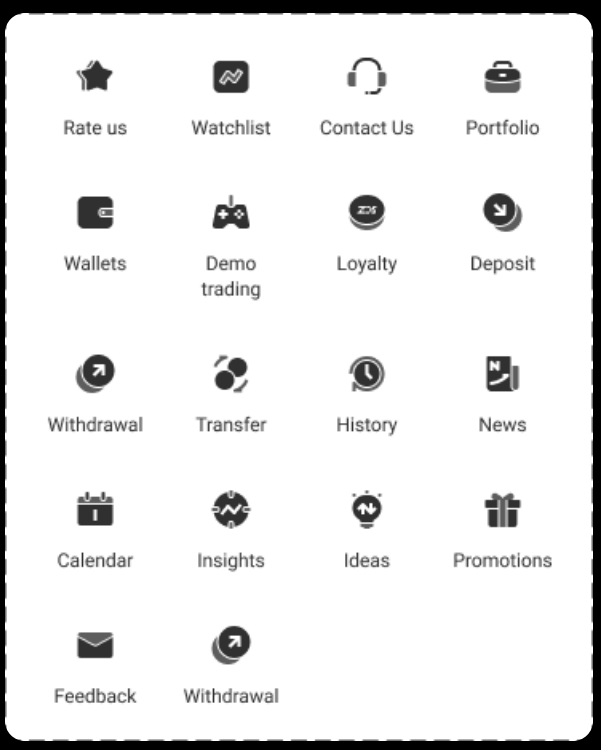
*CAN'T TRADE?* ***THE SCREEN SAYS WHY****, AND WHAT HAPPENS NEXT: WHEN THE MARKET REOPENS, WHICH ACCOUNT TO USE, WHO TO CONTACT.*

## COMPONENT: TRADING-ACCOUNT CARD · SIX TYPES, DEFAULT AND SELECTED




*DEPOSIT, SPREAD AND LEVERAGE SIT IN THE* ***SAME PLACE ON EVERY CARD****. THIS IS WHAT MADE "COMPARE, DON'T REMEMBER" POSSIBLE.*

## ONE ICON FAMILY




*EVERY ENTRY POINT ON HOME IS* ***ONE FAMILY****.*

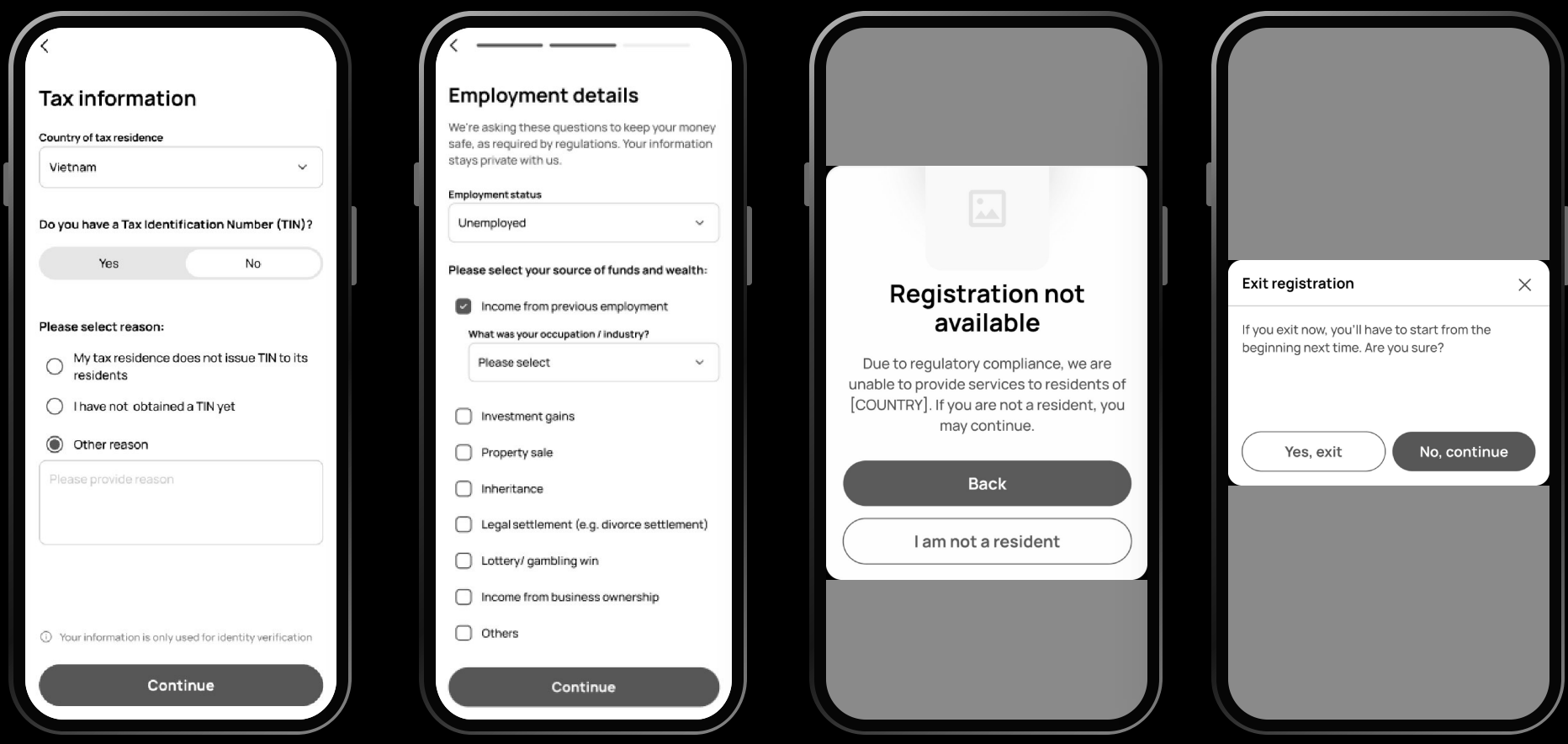
# SPECIFY EVERY SCENARIO

## THE DECISION

*EACH BRANCH OF ONBOARDING IS DOCUMENTED AS **ITS OWN FLOW**. ENGINEERING NEVER HAD TO GUESS AN EDGE CASE.*

## THE BRANCHES

*TAX RESIDENCE WITHOUT A TIN. CHINA VS NON-CHINA PERSONAL DETAILS. UNEMPLOYED OR RETIRED INCOME SOURCES. DOCUMENT TYPES AND REJECTION HANDLING.*




*TAX RESIDENCE: NO TIN* | *UNEMPLOYED OR RETIRED* | *COUNTRY RESTRICTION* | *EXIT CONFIRMATION*

*REGULATORY BLOCKS ARE **HONEST, NOT DEAD ENDS**: THE MODAL EXPLAINS WHY AND OFFERS A COMPLIANT WAY FORWARD FOR NON-RESIDENTS.*

*EXITING MID-REGISTRATION **ASKS BEFORE DISCARDING PROGRESS**. EVERY MODAL KEEPS A SINGLE PRIMARY ACTION.*

---

# WHAT TWELVE DECISIONS ADDED UP TO

**+15%**
*SUCCESSFUL VERIFICATION COMPLETION*

**-24%**
*TRANSACTION COMPLETION TIME*

**-19%**
*USER ERROR RATE, CORE TRADING FLOWS*

*THE **ZEAL DESIGN SYSTEM** KEPT WEB, MOBILE AND PWA CONSISTENT.*

*AN INTERNAL **ACCOUNT-MANAGEMENT PLATFORM** SIMPLIFIED VERIFICATION STATUSES FOR THE BACK OFFICE.*

*VALIDATED WITH **USABILITY TESTING**, THEN ITERATED ON PRODUCT SIGNALS.*

# SIX PEOPLE, FOUR MONTHS

*A CROSS-FUNCTIONAL TEAM OF SIX REWORKED **A LARGE PART OF THE APP**, ONBOARDING INCLUDED, IN ABOUT FOUR MONTHS.*

**1**
**HEAD OF DESIGN**

**2** ME
**SENIOR LEAD DESIGNER**

**3-5**
**MIDDLE AND JUNIOR DESIGNERS**

**6**
**PROJECT MANAGER**

## MY PART

- *SPOTTING THE GAP BETWEEN **ONE UNIVERSAL SIGN-UP** AND VERY DIFFERENT USERS*
- *WORKING WITH **ANALYTICS DATA** AND **COMPLIANCE** REQUIREMENTS*
- *REWORKING THE USER SCENARIOS*
- *DESIGNING THE **ADAPTIVE ONBOARDING LOGIC***
- *SIMPLIFYING THE FORMS*
- *SCREEN SEQUENCE AND VISUAL HIERARCHY*
- *CHECKING THE NEW FLOW END TO END **WITH THE TEAM***

## WHAT CHANGED

- ✓ *ONE KYC BECAME **SEGMENTED SCENARIOS***
- ✓ *COMPLIANCE RULES MAPPED TO REAL CLIENT CATEGORIES*
- ✓ *OPTIONAL FIELDS LEFT THE FIRST STEPS*
- ✓ *BIG FORMS BECAME SHORT, SEQUENTIAL STEPS*
- ✓ *ONBOARDING DEPENDS ON **COUNTRY** AND ITS RULES*
- ✓ *NEW INTERFACE AND VISUAL HIERARCHY*
- ✓ *A CLEAR REASON TO FINISH REGISTRATION*
- ✓ *THE PRODUCT OPENS **BEFORE** REGISTRATION*
- ✓ *A FLEXIBLE STRUCTURE TO KEEP BUILDING ON*

*PRODUCT, LEGAL AND UX LIMITS HAD TO AGREE. IT WAS **NEVER JUST A NEW SKIN**.*

*ONE OVERLOADED PATH BECAME ONE THAT **KNOWS WHO IT'S TALKING TO**.*

